



Your **Free**
Guide

THE INTERNATIONAL STUDENT'S GUIDE TO BRABANT



holland
expat center
south



www.hollandexpatcenter.com: The most comprehensive website for internationals living and working in Brabant.

Newsletter: Subscribe to our monthly newsletter and get up-to-date news about the region!

www.hollandexpatcenter.com/newsletter/

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LinkedIn - The Holland Expat Center

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Events: Meet other internationals living in the area, and get information about important topics!

Check www.hollandexpatcenter.com/events/ for more information!



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Holland Expat Center South

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Opening Hours

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Please note
that Holland
Expat Center South
is currently open for
appointments
only.

Please note that there is no IND available on Fridays,
and it is therefore not possible to pick up your residence permit.

• Expat Information Desk Breda

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Mozartlaan 35, 4837 EH Breda
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Opening Hours

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Holland Expat Center South is closed on public holidays.

www.hollandexpatcenter.com

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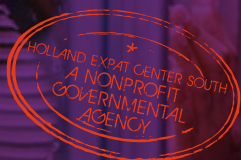
Holland Expat Center South is
your starting point for information
about settling into Brabant.

If you ever have any questions,
please feel free to contact us.

We are here to assist you!

Kind regards,

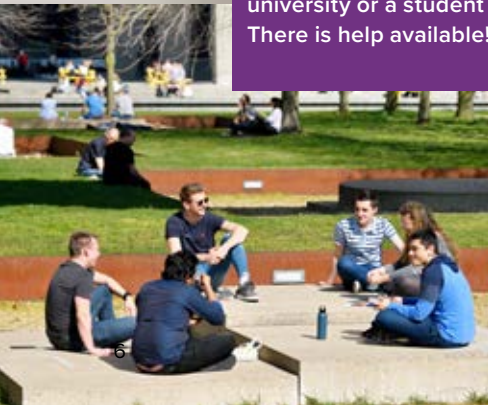
Holland Expat Center South Team





Covid-19 has changed all of our lives. Aside from more online activities, there are also more events that are taking place outdoors.

These have been especially difficult times for international students. Know that there is support for you available. If you are struggling, please contact the international office of your university or a student organization. There is help available!



ABOUT THE EXPAT CENTER

Holland Expat Center South is a one-stop shop for expats living and working in Brabant. Our mission is to promote and support international companies, highly skilled migrants, scientific researchers, and EU citizens by offering a fast and easy procedure for formalities, and providing information about the region.

At Holland Expat Center South, internationals can obtain information, as well as arrange the formal procedures regarding settlement in the Netherlands, including the municipal basic administration and residence documents. This applies to internationals living and/or working in one of the participating municipalities.

The Expat Center also provides regional information, and organizes events for the international community. These services are available free of charge, to every international living in the region.

Holland Expat Center South is a joint initiative of the participating municipalities, the Immigration and Naturalisation Services (IND), and the province of Noord-Brabant.



WELCOME TO THE NETHERLANDS!

The Netherlands has always been an outward looking nation. Its coastal location and proud seafaring tradition have ensured that Dutch navigators and adventurers have been featured prominently throughout history in international exploration, colonisation and trade. This has given the country a role in international affairs that is disproportionate to its size, and has resulted in a cosmopolitan outlook and entrepreneurial attitude. The Dutch people have also developed a taste for the exotic, and have embraced foreign cultures while maintaining their own unique identity.

History of The Netherlands

The land that now forms the Netherlands has been inhabited for about 100.000 years. However, the country's recorded history really began around 57 BC with the Roman conquest, led by Julius Caesar. During that time, the Romans built the first military forts and cities, and introduced writing. Following the decline of the Roman Empire, the Netherlands became part of the Holy Roman Empire.

1000 BC - Local farmers began to drain and cultivate the land. Higher productivity allowed workers to become tradesmen. Markets developed, towns and cities grew rapidly, and a new mercantile middle class arose.

1000 BC

1400 1500

16th Century - The Netherlands became a possession of the Habsburg dynasty.

1548 - The Hapsburg ruler, Charles V, granted the Seventeen Provinces of the Netherlands nominal independent status.

1568 - Charles' son Philip II of Spain, a devout Catholic, was appalled by the success of the Reformation in the region and the rise of Calvinism. He passed a sentence condemning all 3 million inhabitants of the Netherlands to death as heretics, which prompted a revolt.

1579 - Led by William of Orange, the Dutch declared full independence from Spain and formed the 'United Provinces'. The Spanish lost control of the Netherlands after 20 years, but the war lasted another 60 years.

1430-1433 - Duke Philip the Good of Burgundy reunited the republics, which is considered the moment when the Dutch became a nation. The region's trade developed rapidly, especially in the areas of shipping and transport.

17th Century - The Golden Age

The nation flourished, but a slow decline set in following full independence.

1648 - A peace treaty of Westphalia confirmed the independence of the United Provinces. The country became known overseas as 'Holland', and became an important trading centre in Northern Europe, and founded colonies around the world.

1806 - Napoleon restyled the Netherlands into the Kingdom of Holland, with his brother Louis as king. He quickly annexed the fledgling nation into the French Empire when Louis began to put Dutch interests ahead of those of France.

1815 - Following the defeat of Napoleon, the country became an independent monarchy, once again. This 'United Kingdom of the Netherlands' originally consisted of what is now the Netherlands and Belgium.

1830 - The Belgians declared independence from the North.

1848 - Unrest across Europe prompted King William II to agree to democratic reform, and the Netherlands became a constitutional monarchy.

1600

1700

1800

1795 - Napoleon Bonaparte occupied the country and encountered little resistance from a nation that largely supported his republican ideals.

1914 - The Netherlands remained neutral when World War I broke out.

1939 - The country declared its neutrality again at the outbreak of World War II.

May 1940 - Nazi Germany invaded the country and remained for 5 years.

5 May 1945 - The country was liberated.

1950-60 - The Dutch economy expanded rapidly and immigration was encouraged, first from Italy and Spain, and then from Turkey and Morocco. Combined with immigration from former colonies (Indonesia, Surinam and Netherlands Antilles), the Netherlands became the multicultural society it is today.

1960-70 - Class and religious divisions began to break down. The Netherlands was a founding member of both the European Union (EU) and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO).

1999 - The Dutch participated in the introduction of the Euro.

1900

1950

2000

2001 - The world's first same-sex marriage takes place in Amsterdam.

2002 - The Euro replaces the Dutch guilder; regulated euthanasia is legalised

30 April 2013 - Prince Willem-Alexander appointed as the King, having ascended the throne following his mother's abdication, Queen Beatrix. At the time of her abdication at age 75, Beatrix was the oldest reigning monarch in the country's history.

INSIGHTS

GOVERNMENT

- The Netherlands is a **constitutional monarchy**: the position of the monarch is laid down in the Constitution.
- **King Willem-Alexander** is the Dutch head of state and, together with the ministers, makes up the government.
- **Equal rights for everyone** are guaranteed by law, and egalitarianism forms a central belief of Dutch society.
- The ministers make up **the Cabinet**, which is chaired by the Prime Minister.
- The **Council of State** is the Netherlands' oldest High Council of State. Founded by Emperor Charles V in 1531, it is still the government's chief advisory body.
- All **Dutch nationals older than 18** may vote and stand in elections for the House of Representatives.
- **Parliament** (the States General) consists of two chambers: the Senate (the upper house, with 75 members) is elected by the provincial councils) and the House of Representatives (the lower house, with 150 members).
- **All Acts of Parliament** have to be passed by both houses of parliament.
- The Netherlands has **many political parties**, which is encouraged by the electoral system.
- The **House of Parliament** is elected by proportional representation.

- **Encounters:** Virtually everyone **shakes hands** in the Netherlands, both upon greeting and upon departure. In informal situations (with friends or relatives) women and men may also exchange three kisses, on alternating cheeks. Men only exchange three kisses with women; not with men.
- **Flowers:** Dutch homes are often full of house plants, and flowers are frequently given as gifts when visiting friends or relatives.
- **Communication:** Many foreigners can **find the Dutch direct** and abrupt. However, there is no intention to be rude. The Dutch say what they mean and speak their minds!
- **Meetings:** Dutch society puts great emphasis on the need for people at all levels to have their say in decision-making processes, and on finding consensus. This can slow the decision-making process, but ensures that everyone's view is heard.
- **Punctuality:** It is important to be punctual. Call if you are delayed, and avoid canceling meetings at the last minute. Don't forget that meetings usually adhere to a strict agenda, and finish at an appointed time.
- **Dress code:** In sectors such as banking and law, the dress code is formal and traditional. But in many other industries it is casual. The focus in the Netherlands is on content rather than form.
- **Work-life balance:** Dutch people **value their personal time**. Business lunches are preferred over dinners. If you want to motivate Dutch workers, time off works better than money!
- **Dinner:** It is common to bring a bottle of wine and flowers if you visit someone for dinner. The bottle is very often put to one side and will be enjoyed on another occasion.
- **Telephoning:** People say their name right away on the phone (usually both first and last name), at work and at home, both when answering and calling.
- **Common expressions:** 'Gezellig' is a bonding expression used in social situations, which translates loosely to 'Isn't this nice?' 'Doe Normaal!' is an expression, which means 'Just behave normally,' and has a strong resonance. This warning keeps kids and adults alike in check, and prevents them from stepping out of line and being too outrageous!



**WHY OTHERS
CHOOSE
BRAINPORT
EINDHOVEN**

- Kacper Sawicz, Poland -



Why did you choose to study in Brabant? "When I found the Bachelor of Data Science on Tilburg and Eindhoven University (a joint degree) I was very excited. Tilburg University and the Technical University of Eindhoven provided me with a unique opportunity to combine social and technical skills. The number of interesting electives is huge, we can learn econometrics and entrepreneurial techniques in Tilburg or algorithms, statistics, databases and mathematics in Eindhoven while paying only one university fee. Both universities are also high in rankings, Eindhoven is in top 100 of world universities in general and Tilburg is top 20 economy university in the world."

What do you like about the group projects? "This well-executed group project teaches you far more than a standard course. After you graduate, you will feel more comfortable and self-confident when you will transition into the workplace."

How do you like living in Brabant? "I enjoy it more every year. The people here have a general kindness to them. They are also not afraid to have fun."

What do you think about the study culture in the Netherlands? "A close relationship with my teachers helps me to ask questions during the lectures and sending them numerous questions about their subject."

What advice do you have for other international students? "A first visit to the Netherlands if you can. At Tilburg University there are 'open days' and 'student for a day'- events several times a year. Or you can always contact one of the student ambassadors, who will give you a personal tour and answer all of the questions that you have in mind."



Connecting the international office

When you have any questions concerning formalities connected to studying in Brabant, please contact the international office of your university.



Eindhoven University of Technology

The service Education and Student Affairs (ESA) is the central point at TU/e where you receive a variety of services in the field of education.

www.tue.nl/en/our-university/about-the-university/support-services/education-and-student-affairs/



Tilburg University

Find information on study and university life related matters on two website.

www.tilburguniversity.edu/students



Avans University of Applied Sciences

For questions in relation to studying at Avans University of Applied Sciences contact Student T +31 (0)88 525 7550

www.avans.nl/international/about-avans/contact



Fontys University of Applied Sciences

Here you can find all kinds of practical information for your stay in the Netherlands and the support Fontys can offer you.

fontys.edu/Study-at-Fontys/Living-in-the-Netherlands.htm



"Coming to the Netherlands, and especially Brabant, to study is a great opportunity to broaden your horizons and experience the highest level of education. It allows you to meet people from all around the globe and gives you different perspectives on the job market."





2 MOVING TO BRABANT

- 2.1 Burger Service Nummer (BSN)
- 2.2 Residence Permit
- 2.3 Work Permit
- 2.4 Driver's License



2.1 Burger Service Nummer (BSN)

Every person residing in the Netherlands has a registration number: *Burger Service Nummer* (BSN). One is issued to Dutch citizens when they are born and registered into the Population Register, and to migrants who start to live in the Netherlands when they register at the municipality. You can register for a BSN as soon as you have moved into your new residence. The university will support you in the process.

Keep an eye on the announcements of your University about the town hall registration sessions!

- You may only obtain a BSN for yourself and your children (who are younger than 18).
- You must provide an address.
- You must present a valid passport. A different identification document can only be presented by nationals of an EU member state. (A driver's license is not accepted as an identity card.)
- You must appear in person.

If you are not a national of an EU member state, Liechtenstein, Norway, Iceland, or Switzerland, you must have a note/sticker in your passport that permits you to stay and work in the Netherlands.

Take the following items to your appointment:

- **Birth certificate** (legalized)
Tip! Check the website of the Dutch Ministry of Foreign Affairs for legalization procedures with your country of origin.
- **Marriage certificate** (legalized)
- **Valid passport**

Tip! Make sure that your passport is valid for as long as possible.

- **Dutch housing rental or purchase contract** (or consent of the principal occupant)

2.2 Residence Permit

- Non-EU citizens must apply for a residence permit.
- Everyone over the age of 12 must carry a valid ID at all times.

Study Visa

The International Office of your university is the go-to contact about your study visa.

Replacing a lost or stolen residence permit

1. File a report with the police.
2. Complete the **‘Vervanging, vernieuwing of eerste aanvraag vreemdelingen-document’** IND form.
3. Mail the following items to the IND:
 - Police report
 - Copy of your passport
 - Copy of your residence permit (if available)
 - The IND form



Mail to the following mailing address:

Immigratie-en Naturalisatiedienst, Postbus 5 9560 AA Ter Apel

The cost is dependent on the type of residence permit. For more information visit www.ind.nl or contact Holland Expat Center South.



2.3 Work Permit

Internationals who have successfully finished a Bachelor's or Master's program in the Netherlands may apply for an Orientation Year Permit for graduates. This permit allows recent graduates from non-EU countries to stay in the Netherlands for a period of up to twelve months, while seeking suitable employment. Holland Expat Center South can guide you through the process. [\(Read more in the 'Working in Brabant' section.\)](#)



Have you successfully finished a Bachelor's or Master's program in the Netherlands?

Then you may apply for an Orientation Year Permit for graduates! This permit allows recent graduates from non-EU countries to stay in the Netherlands for a period of up to twelve months, while seeking suitable employment.

2.4 Driving in the Netherlands

- Residents of the Netherlands are not allowed to drive a car registered in another country (after a certain period of time).
- You must exchange your current driver's license or apply for a Dutch driver's license.
- You are allowed to drive in the Netherlands with your current driver's license for 180 days.

The following are required to drive a car in the Netherlands:

- A valid driver's license
- Third party insurance
- Car must be registered

Exchanging a driver's license

Some internationals are able to exchange their driver's license for a Dutch one:

- Expats who have the 30% tax facility status (nationality does not matter).
- Citizens of the countries of the EU or EFTA.
- Driver's licences issued in some other countries can also be exchanged.

For more information, visit www.rdw.nl.

For most of the above-mentioned countries, the driver's license will be valid for 10 years. But before it elapses, it is required to exchange the license for a Dutch one.

Driving exam

Those who do not fit in the above categories are legally allowed to use their foreign driver's license for 185 days after arrival, then they must pass the regular Dutch theory and driving tests.

- It is possible to take both the theory and driving tests in English.
- Dutch driver's licenses are generally issued for 10 years.

Formalities

- Exchange your driver's license for a Dutch one (if applicable).
- Return foreign driver's license via home country. (Be sure to make a copy!)
- Note expiration dates of all permits and licenses, and make sure you reapply on time!

Meilivia Angelicka, Indonesia
- Industrial Engineering,
Fontys Hogescholen Eindhoven



How did you prepare for your international move to Brabant? "Fontys Hogescholen has an agent in Indonesia to help international students with all the practical preparations, even applying for a visa. So that was quite easy.... Actually, the most difficult thing to adjust to here is the Dutch weather."

What are your plans after graduation? "I want to work for a company that has firms here as well as in Indonesia. I know that a lot of alumni from Indonesia work for Philips, so that offers a lot of possibilities. Eventually I will return to Indonesia, because I promised my parents I would come back. By working here for the first years, I will become stronger to face the challenges in Indonesia, for instance concerning corruption."

What is leading in choosing your first job in the Netherlands? "For me, the company is more important than the location. This country is quite small, so commuting is no problem. Lots of people I know live in Brabant but work in the Randstad and they find it very manageable."

Would you like to keep living in Brabant? "Yes. I like the region and the central location. You can go almost everywhere in the country from here and it will never take more than three hours. I also like the city of Eindhoven, where I live. It's not too crowded, but still an interesting globalising city. And the inhabitants are very friendly. A friend of mine, who studies in Japan, came to visit me a while ago and he was so enthusiastic that he also wants to move here."

What advice do you have for other international students? "Be aware of the difference between universities, that are more focused on research, and 'hogescholen', that are more focused on practice. Most other countries don't have that difference, so most people aren't used to it."

**WHY OTHERS
CHOSE
BRAINPORT
EINDHOVEN**

Catalina Susnea, Romania

- Software Engineering, Fontys

University of Applied Sciences Eindhoven



Fontys

University of
Applied Sciences

How did you end up studying in Brabant? “I visited a gathering of the Romanian International University Fair and there was a representative of Fontys Hogescholen present. I found it to have one of the best practical studies for applied sciences. And Eindhoven was one of the cities I wanted to live, because it’s nice and not too big plus it has an airport so I can easily travel to Romania when I want.”

How did you prepare for your move to Brabant? “I contacted an international organisation called Edmundo and asked them about all the information I needed to live and study in the Netherlands. All the universities pay for this organisation, so I found it to be trustworthy. For other questions I had, for instance about accommodation, supermarkets and other living issues, I used Facebook. But that’s not always reliable. The only credible information is to be found via school.”

Will you stay in Brabant? “I have good hope to find an interesting job here. All the companies in this area are very keen on innovation and that suits my education and interests. And I start an internship at Philips soon, so maybe that will lead to a job later?”

Would you like to keep living in Brabant? “I think so. I had the best years of my life here. I met lots of friends because there are so many young people here. And I found lots of nice parks in the region as well, I like that.”

What advice do you have for other international students? “If you want to study in the technology field, you can find many opportunities and interesting companies here that can help you grow. And the schools and universities are very high ranked.”



The housing available in Brabant will probably not be the same as you are used to. How you see this depends on your experience in your home country! There are many types of housing available in Brabant -- and many places to live. The choice is yours!



3. LIVING IN BRABANT

- 3.1 Renting
- 3.2 Utilities
- 3.3 Waste and Recycling
- 3.4 Places to Live
Eindhoven, Meierijstad, Tilburg, Breda
- 3.5 Banking
- 3.6 Taxation
- 3.7 Insurance
- 3.8 Social security
- 3.9 Health care



Europeans comment that housing is expensive and the gardens are small, while Americans frequently find that the rooms are small, particularly children's bedrooms. But those coming from places such as Singapore - where land is also at a premium - may see things differently!

The Netherlands is one of the most densely populated countries in Europe, with almost 488 people per square kilometer. The high population density explains why many houses are small and compact, but Dutch builders are skilled in maximizing the use of space!

Dutch housing varies from studio apartments, to traditional apartments, and larger detached and semi-detached houses.

One bathroom per household is common, and showers are more common than baths. Dining rooms are a luxury. (Normally, there is an open kitchen and living room with a dining area.)

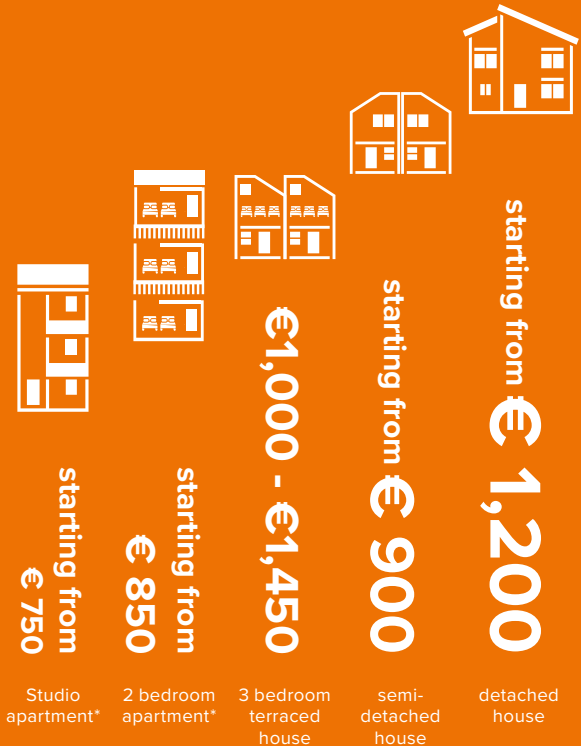
Most houses are well insulated, and newer buildings will have double-glazed windows. Utility rooms are only found in larger houses.

3.1 Renting

The housing market in the region is mainly controlled by commercial real estate agents. There are also non-commercial **woningcorporaties** (housing agencies).

Suitable accommodation is usually readily available. However, it will be more difficult to find accommodation during August/September and January/February, due to the arrival of students and university staff. If you plan to arrive during these months, begin to look for accommodation as early as possible.

Rent varies widely, but in the private market you could expect to pay the following (excluding service costs and utilities):



TiP!

Expats should insist on the '**diplomatic clause**', which allows them to break the contract quickly if they need to return to their home country unexpectedly.

* Unfurnished



If you are still looking for a student accommodation, please find further housing information provided by your university:

TU/e

EINDHOVEN
UNIVERSITY OF
TECHNOLOGY



Understanding Society

avans

university of
applied sciences



University of
Applied Sciences

Eindhoven University of Technology

www.tue.nl/en/education/become-a-tue-student/housing/

Tilburg University

www.tilburguniversity.edu/students/studying/studentlife/accommodation

Avans University of Applied Science

www.avans.nl/international/studying/practical-information/accommodation

Fontys University of Applied Science

fontys.edu/Study-at-Fontys/Practical-information-1/Accommodation-studyguide.htm

Types of rental properties

There are three types of rental properties available in the Netherlands:

- **Ongemeubileerd** (Bare): No decorations and furniture, flooring or light fixtures.
- **Gestoffeerd** (Unfurnished): Only decorations, such as carpets and curtains.
- **Gemeubileerd** (Furnished): Completely decorated and furnished with all appliances.

Ask if the rental agency charges a mediation fee! The Dutch Consumer Authority (**Autoriteit Consument en Markt**), has ruled that agencies are only allowed to charge the party they are representing. If that is the landlord then the agency cannot charge the tenant and the tenant does not have to pay the agency.

Major points to look for in a rental contract, include:

- The correct rental price, and whether it includes service charges and energy bills, etc.
- The correct deposit (1-2 month's rent is normal)
- The correct date of entry.
- The duration of the contract. Most are fixed for one year, with a notice period of one month from either party.
- Who is responsible for maintenance and repairs. Make sure it is clear who looks after the garden as well as the building.
- If the house belongs to someone who might want it back at an inconvenient time (e.g. someone on assignment outside of the Netherlands), it may be better to fix the contract for a longer period.

3.2 Utilities

Each address has a single supplier for **water**. When you move into your new home, the water meter must also be read, and you must notify the supplier that you are the new resident. Your real estate agent can usually help you complete the required forms.

It is not always necessary to have a land-line telephone. Nowadays, quite a few expats are choosing to live without one, and use their mobiles to stay in touch.

All GSM **mobile phones** will work in the Netherlands, but it is still advised to switch to a Dutch SIM card when you arrive to avoid paying more for your calls. Go to a mobile phone supplier in town to get a new card and phone if required.

Internet is available through the telephone line or through cable television. In each case there is a number of different suppliers.



Ask the outgoing resident or your real estate agent about the supplier.

Most cable suppliers sell not only basic TV, but also digital TV, Internet and telephone services. In order to take any of these services, you must first purchase basic cable TV.

3.3 Waste and Recycling

In many cities, household waste and organic kitchen and garden waste are collected separately, at set times. However, those living in apartments do not separate their organic and household waste. Instead, they deposit their trash in underground containers that are located near their building. A **stadspas** (city pass) is required to access these containers.



Most municipalities have an app that provides information about waste collection days!

Several **kringloop** (recycling) schemes exist in the Netherlands, although these may vary slightly depending on where you live. Many areas have a policy that each house should have recycling facilities within 500 meters. When you buy bottled drinks, you will sometimes pay a small deposit, which is refundable when you return the empty bottles to the grocery store. There are machines located inside grocery stores where you can deposit these empty plastic or glass bottles. You will receive a receipt, which you can use to pay for your groceries.

Bottle banks for recycling either clear, green and brown **glass**, and **plastics** can be found outside many supermarkets. In some cities, they pick up plastic. **Paper/cardboard** is usually picked up once a month. On the day of pick up, you are requested to bundle it and place it on the curb near your house.

There are also collection points for unwanted **clothes and shoes** often located near grocery stores. Before depositing the items into the bin, place them in a tied plastic bag.

Bins for used **batteries and lightbulbs** can be found inside certain stores, including most grocery stores. Larger items can be taken to your local **milieustraten** (waste recycling points).



Cure is a partnership of the municipalities of Eindhoven, Valkenswaard and Geldrop-Mierlo. Cure provides waste collection in these municipalities, including recycling points.

- Free for residents of mentioned cities
- Admission only with your personal city pass containing a passport photo
- Separating waste at the waste recycling points is mandatory
- Asbestos needs be registered in advance

For more information, go to: www.cure-afvalbeheer.nl/en/



Eindhoven Timeline

Eindhoven is one of the oldest cities in the Netherlands: The site on which it stands is the location of one of the oldest settlements in the Netherlands, with a history that dates back 2500 years.

1232 - Granted its town charter by the Duke of Brabant. At the time 'Endehoven' consisted of around 170 houses and a castle. Over the centuries however, its position located on key trade routes made it a target of enemy armies, and it was burned to the ground on several occasions.

1200

1629 - Eindhoven became part of the Netherlands.



Significant reminders of the past include the 17th century Mariënhage cloister and the gothic St. Catharina Church (19th century).

19th century - During the Industrial Revolution the textile and cigar industries flourished, and Eindhoven began to grow.

1891 - Philips founded their first light bulb factory in the city.

1920s - Its position as an important manufacturing centre became firmly established with the arrival of car and truck manufacturer Van Doorne's Automobiel Fabriek (DAF).

Unprecedented growth led to the annexation of the neighboring villages: Woensel, Gestel, Strijp, Tongelre, and Stratum.

1940s - During World War II, parts of Eindhoven were destroyed by heavy bombing and only a few buildings survived.

1944 - Eindhoven was liberated on 18 September!

1900

2000

Recent years have seen a local renaissance, as Eindhoven has become a city of design, technology and knowledge.



3.4 Places to live

INSIGHTS

BRABANT

Most people have heard about the multinational electronics giant Philips, and Eindhoven's renowned football team, PSV - one of Europe's best! Culture buffs probably know about the Van Abbemuseum or De Pont, which are contemporary art museums with an international reputation; the Design Academy Eindhoven, renown as one of the world's best design schools; or Efteling, a famous amusement park that has won several awards. But Brabant has even more to offer!

- **The five largest cities** (Eindhoven, Tilburg, Breda, 's-Hertogenbosch and Helmond) form '**BrabantStad**': the second largest city network in the Netherlands. (The largest is the **Randstad**: Amsterdam, The Hague and Rotterdam.)
- **High-tech industries and services** are located all over the region.
- The region is dotted with **picturesque villages** and **forests**.
- Noord-Brabant is often referred to as '**Brabant**'.
- '**s-Hertogenbosch** is the capital of the province.
- Brabant covers an area of 5,081 km², making it **the second largest province in the Netherlands** after Gelderland.
- The population of Brabant is **2.593.000**. (Provincie Noord-Brabant, February 2022)



Mira Dreessen
Project Manager at Brainport Development

Studying in a foreign country can be daunting at times. Next to being challenged by your study, you are also setting up your own life, away from family and friends. Believe me, I've been there, and I too took on the challenge to make the Netherlands my new home. And to this day, I do not regret it, so I'd like to share some tips:

1. LEARN CONVERSATIONAL DUTCH

Invest a bit of your time to learn some Dutch phrases as conversation starters. See it as some form of respect towards the culture you chose to mingle with and the Dutch will appreciate it very much! In social settings as well as (future) work life. It helps me a lot to settle and feel at home.

2. STAY CONNECTED WITH LOCALS AND OTHER INTERNATIONALS

In the Netherlands it is not common to live on the university campus, but to rent an accommodation that's situated in the city, among locals. Keep an open mind and you will experience that others will react the same. I've had great experiences with previous neighbours and spontaneous shared street dinners. And while we are in the transition towards a new normal, community apps such as Acivitree and Enjoyn.co can help to stay connected.

3. IT'S OKAY TO ASK FOR HELP

Hopefully, this guide provides you with some background information and tips on how to settle into your new environment. Have fun and explore! However, if you'd like to ask a question in person about topics listed here, you can contact Holland Expat Center South both online or in person.



Eindhoven West (Strijp)

Strijp is geographically the largest district in Eindhoven, though a large part is taken up by Eindhoven Airport and surrounding industrial areas. The project Strijp-S is turning 66 acres into an inspiring environment with a mix of living, working and recreation.

Notable: Tegenbosch and De Herdgang sports centres, the Philips-De Jongh Park, the Evoluon conference centre, Strijp-S Train Station, Welschap golfcourse, and the International School Eindhoven (ISE).

Proximity: The A2 gives good access to the north, south and west.

Eindhoven West (Meerhoven)

Eindhoven South (Stratum and Gestel)

Southeast of the centre, Stratum is bordered to the north by a canal and industrial area. Genneper Park lies near the city centre, while the area south includes farms and other open areas.

Proximity: Bordered to the south by the A67, and the A2 north going to Tilburg, Breda and Amsterdam.

Notable: The DAF Trucks plant, High Tech Campus Eindhoven, the Eindhoven Museum, the Environmental Education Centre, Tongelreep Swimming Centre, the Ice Sports Centre, and various playing fields.

Eindhoven North (Woensel North and South)

Woensel lies north of Eindhoven centre, and one of the main routes into the city, Kennedylaan, runs through it.

Notable: Winkelcentrum Woensel (largest shopping area outside of the city center), the Bokt and Woensel sporting complexes, Catharina and Maxima Medical Hospitals, Eindhoven University of Technology (TU/e), and Fontys University of Applied Sciences.

Eindhoven East (Tongelre)

Tongelre lies to the east of Eindhoven's centre. It is green and open in some parts, particularly in the north, which contains the Karpendonkse.

Proximity: The area is bordered by the inner-ring road to the west, and the A270 gives quick access to Helmond.

Notable: Lake and Eckart Forest and The DAF Museum.

Eindhoven Centre

Eindhoven's city centre is a lively place! Most of the main hotels and restaurants are found here.

Notable: Holland Expat Center South, Town Hall, the Eindhoven Centraal Train Station, Bus Station, Philips Stadion, Eindhoven Central Library, Van Abbemuseum, and the Philips museum.

Best developed from an agricultural centre into an industrial centre with residential areas. Within 15 minutes walking or cycling, you can enjoy many beautiful forests and pastures. It serves as an entry to the unique national landscape, Het Groene Woud (the Green Woods).

Population: 28.804

Location: 10 km northwest of Eindhoven, between the A2 and A58 motorways

Bladel is the economical heart of the 'Brabantse Kempen' and is made up of five villages: Bladel, Casteren, Hapert, Hoogeloon and Netersel. It is an attractive municipality that has much to offer business owners, and is a nice place to live!

Veldhoven is a growing and thriving suburban town that offers urban and rural serenity, and nature, with a lot of greenery. At the Kempen Campus, enjoy an unprecedented number of sports and cultural activities. ASML is headquartered in Veldhoven.

Population: 44.159 (living) and 25.000 (working)

Location: 7 km from Eindhoven, on the A2 and A67

Eersel is well-known for its green scenery and relaxed atmosphere. It is referred to as the 'Pearl of the Kempen'. Its old market square is one of its tourist attractions. There are also a lot of marked cycle- and hiking routes. Its beach, the E3-strand is used for swimming, and is a popular location for dance and music festivals during the summer months.

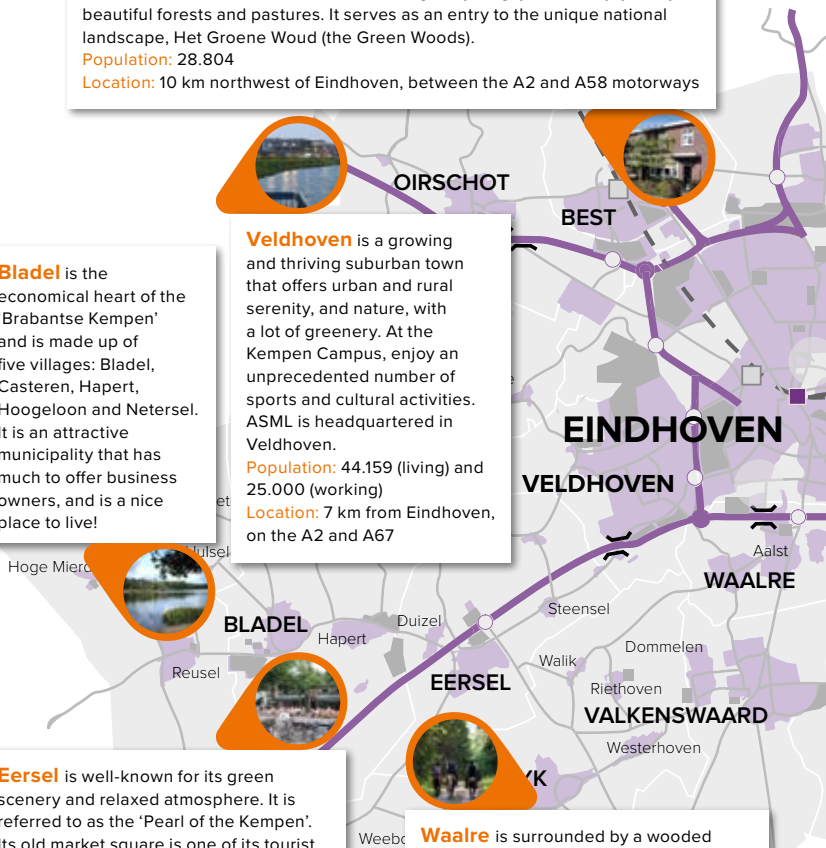
Population: 18.387

Location: 15 km from Eindhoven, and close to Belgium

Waalre is surrounded by a wooded area, with 600 hectares of forest for hiking, biking and horseback riding. The village was founded in the 8th century, but the real growth took place during the 20th century. The High Tech Campus and ASML are both within cycling distance.

Population: 16.889

Location: 6 kilometres south of Eindhoven, directly off the A2/N2





Son en Breugel offers a quality mix in terms of living environment, social climate, security and safety, employment and accessibility. There is a large area of forest around Son, which is pleasant for walking and cycling.

Population: 16.350

Location: 7 km north of Eindhoven, near the A50/A2

Nuenen was once home to Vincent van Gogh, and is where he painted the 'Potato Eaters'. The village has existed for nearly 1,500 years, and prides itself on being a quiet and green place to live.

Population: 22.214

Location: 8 km northeast of Eindhoven

HELMOND

DEURNE

Geldrop-Mierlo was once home to a thriving textile industry, but today, most people work in other industries.

Population: 38.000

Location: 7 km from Eindhoven

Helmond is one of the five largest cities in Brabant. First mention of the city was in a document in 1179 by Pope Alexander III. Duke Hendrik I of Brabant founded the city in 1225 and it was granted a charter in 1232. It has an illustrious past in the textile and metal industry. New, knowledge-based employment opportunities are concentrated around the Food Technology Park Brainport. Helmond is at the heart of De Groote Peel National Park and is known for its new city districts Dierdonk and Brandevoort. Its Saturday market, which has been operating since 1538, was voted the best in the Netherlands.

Population: 89.797

Location: 12 km from Eindhoven

Heeze-Leende's great landscapes dominate the panorama in which the three villages are spread over. More than 900.000 people visit its forests yearly and go to the municipality to walk, cycle, or to enjoy one of its burgundian terraces. Is well-known for its annual historical and cultural festival, Brabantse Dag.

Population: 15.540 spread over three villages: Heeze, Leende and Sterksel

Location: 10 km southeast of Eindhoven



Meerijstad: Powerful Together

Our DNA

Entrepreneurial

Meerijstad is an enterprising and economically strong municipality with more than 80,000 inhabitants. Meerijstad is located in the middle of the city triangle of Eindhoven, Den Bosch and Nijmegen. Eindhoven Airport is easily and quickly accessible. Our municipality offers vibrancy, activity, peace and space.

Decisive

We have a culture of thinking and doing. Our inhabitants like to take the initiative. There is a reason why major companies such as Mars, Jumbo, Sligro, Friesland Campina, Agrifirm, Udea and VanderLande, Volvo and the Van Berkel Group are successfully established in this region.

Engaged

The community spirit in our municipality is great. Many of our inhabitants are active volunteers within the community, for example with local sports or culture. Powerful Together, that's our philosophy.

Our strengths

Food

We are the epicenter of the Agri-Food region. From farm-to-table, we have everything you need. A quarter of the food the Dutch population have on their plate comes from within our municipality. From local cafe to Michelin star restaurant, you can fully enjoy the bounty of what is produced in our region. We are also at the

forefront when it comes to innovation. For example, the Together Against Food Waste movement originated in our municipality.

Culture

There is much to enjoy and experience in our municipality in the field of art and culture. National festivals such as Paaspop, 7th Sunday and Fabriek Magnifique are held and organized here. Cultural hotspot CHV Noordkade in Veghel (which provides music, theatre, art, culture and catering) is an important venue, as is the clog producing village of Sint-Oedenrode and the architectural icon, De Glas Boerderij in Schijndel.





Nature

People who love the countryside and nature and will be enchanted by Meierijstad. With rivers and valleys, the Dommel and the Aadal, the Kienehoef regional park and the Schaapskooi in the Wijbosch Broek (Van Gogh National Park) there is much to enjoy for recreation and relaxation. We also have numerous clubs and associations, activities and events in the field of sport and exercise.

Our daily lives

Home

Renting or buying a house? A house in the countryside or in a more urban environment? Would you like to be a short distance from nature and amenities? There is a wide range of housing opportunities in our municipality. Unlike several major cities, there are still opportunities in the housing market in Meierijstad.

Work

Our municipality has more than 45,000 jobs. From seasonal labor to high tech work, we have a demand for all levels of employment. Moreover, due to the presence of local and international companies, there is ample selection in our region.

Life

Meierijstad is a great place to live and work! We have a wide range of facilities. In addition, we are easily accessible by car, bike (via fast bike paths) and public transport (HOV). We also have the Inpat Center, which is happy to help the potential workforce who want to settle in our municipality (www.inpatcenter.nl).





In addition to the rivers and parks our municipality is full of **walking and cycling routes.**



Cultural hotspot CHV Noordkade in Veghel (which provides music, theatre, art, culture and catering) is an important venue



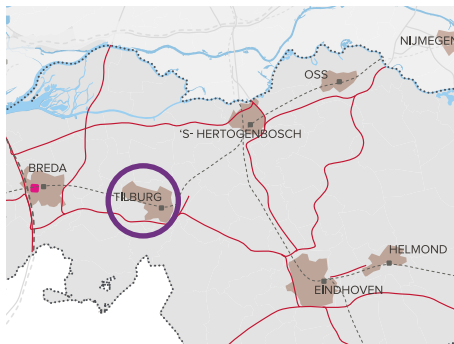
Meerijstad is a great place to **live and work!** We have a wide range of facilities.



Tilburg

Tilburg is changing. The textile city of yesterday has become today's economic beacon. It is a city full of talent - although sometimes a bit shy about showing it off. Hard work is being done on projects that will give Tilburg a new appearance. While the population of the Netherlands as a whole continues to decline, the population of Tilburg has grown by 9% in the last 10 years. It is the sixth largest city in the Netherlands.

Population: 211.726



INTERESTING FACTS

- The sixth largest city in the Netherlands.
- Its population has grown by 9% in the last 10 years.
- An additional 400.000 people live in its surroundings areas.
- Tilburg is the logistics centre for the south of the Netherlands.
- Is situated in the Heart of Brabant (Hart van Brabant) region, which is highly oriented around Social Innovation. Particularly developed within the Leisure, Logistics, Life Sciences, Aerospace & Maintenance branches.
- Tilburg is also a city of students, which gives the city an outstanding pool of talent for modern knowledge-intensive industries.
- Approximately 29.000 students attend Tilburg University and the various universities of applied sciences.
- FujiFILM, Sony, DHL, Epson, Janssen-Cilag, IFF, Otto, Fabory, Schenker, and Bosch Transmission Technology, all have offices located in Tilburg.
- The Tilburg International Club is a non-profit association that provides social and educational activities for internationals living in and around Tilburg.



The structure underlying the origins of Tilburg is a historical monument in itself. Old maps show a pattern unique to the Netherlands, consisting of 12 residential triangles with farm buildings. For centuries farmers grazed their sheep inside these areas; the people living in the region were primarily wool merchants. Weavers working in their homes, and later industrialists, processed the wool into fine textiles.

Those small farming communities, which sprang up around **herdgangen** (herd routes), were located a distance apart and connected by narrow roads, some of which were kilometres long. Labourers, tradesmen and manufacturers built their homes along these connecting roads.

As a result, ribbons of weavers' homes, villas, factories and shops rose up all over Tilburg. The Goirkestraat still remains a blueprint of that traditional street pattern!

1800

1809 - Tilburg obtained city rights from the ruler of the Kingdom of Holland, Louis Napoleon Bonaparte on 18 April.

19th Century - The textile industry flourished, and more laborers settled near their workplace. New residential facilities became necessary and massive building projects sprang up. The old farming communities were transformed into residential districts.

1960s - The flourishing textile industry came to an end.

1957-1982 - Countless Tilburg inhabitants lost their livelihoods when 40 factories were closed.

1962 - The university moved to a campus to the west of the city center.

Factory grounds were open for new purposes. Under the motto of urban innovation, many historical buildings, churches and traditional neighborhoods disappeared from the 1960s onward. As a result, a great deal of cultural heritage was lost in those years.

1900

1960

2000

Today, museums and cultural institutes find their homes in old factories and schools. Convent gardens became public property, and church buildings are used for contemporary purposes.



Tilburg De Reeshof

This area has grown considerably over the last decades. All services can be found and there is a shopping centre (Heyhoef). Some parts are spacious and green, with modern houses. It has its own train station, and the university is just a bicycle ride away.

Tilburg West (Wandelbos and de Reit)

This neighborhood surrounds the university. There is one shopping centre (Westermarkt), and all kinds of services are available. Both rental houses and apartments can be found in this area. The university has its own train station.

Tilburg South (Blaak and Zorgvlied)

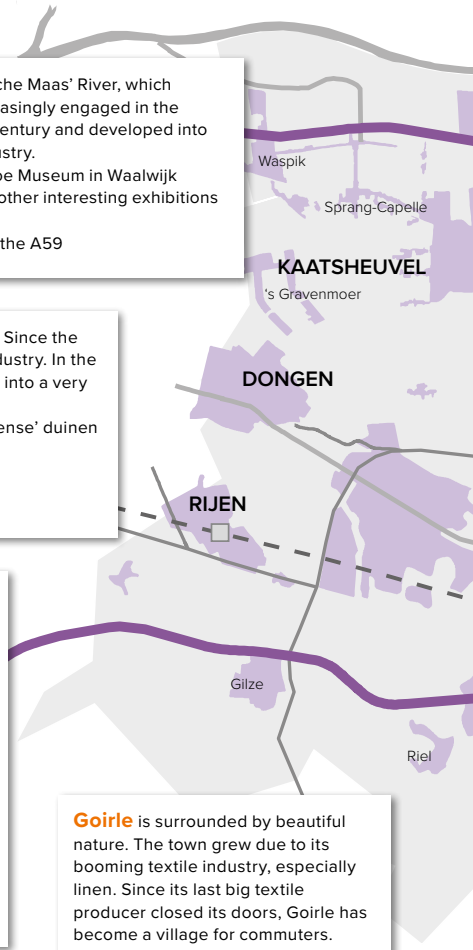
Blaak and Zorgvlied is an area in the south of Tilburg with green areas and ponds, and a small shopping centre. It has schools, daycare centres and medical services.

De Blaak mainly offers residences. Zorgvlied is a residential area in the southwestern part of Tilburg, close to the city centre. There are somewhat older houses, and nice and spacious surroundings.



Tilburg - The City Center

The center is the most lively part of Tilburg. Good quality apartments can be found, and there are also plenty of shopping and entertainment facilities available. Tilburg's main train station is located in the center.



Waalwijk is located on the 'Bergsche Maas' River, which was dug around 1900. The city increasingly engaged in the manufacturing of shoes in the 18th century and developed into an important center of the shoe industry.

Notable: The Dutch Leather and Shoe Museum in Waalwijk shows its own collection, as well as other interesting exhibitions

Population: 46.728

Location: 20 km north of Tilburg, to the A59

Dongen lies next to the De Donge River. Since the 18th century the area has had a leather industry. In the 19th century, the shoe industry developed into a very important sector.

Notable: De Efteling and 'Loonse en Drunense' duinen are within cycling distance

Population: 25.347

Location: 12 km northwest of Tilburg

Gilze-Rijen is one of the oldest areas in Noord-Brabant. To its east and west are vast farming areas, and on its southside it is bordered by Prinsenbos, Annabos and the Ulvenhoutse forests. On the east side is vast agricultural and grassland, while on its west lies the nature area of Suraa. Earlier, leatherwear and the shoe industry were the most important sectors for the area. Today, its strength is in a mixed form of activity that takes place in the municipality.

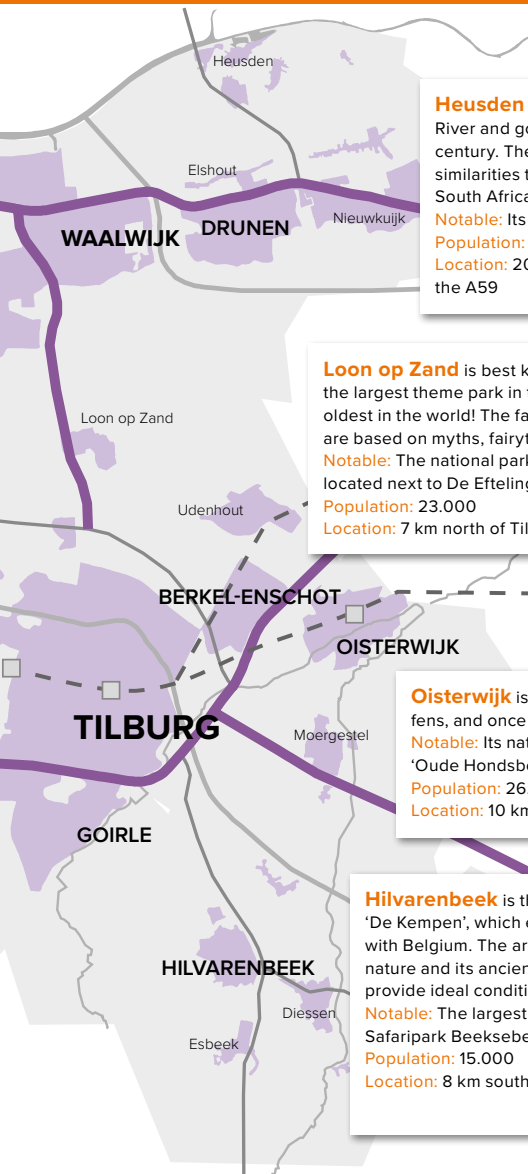
Population: 26.090

Location: Between Tilburg and Breda

Goirle is surrounded by beautiful nature. The town grew due to its booming textile industry, especially linen. Since its last big textile producer closed its doors, Goirle has become a village for commuters.

Population: 23.000

Location: 6 km south of Tilburg



Heusden is situated next to the Maas River and got its city rights around the 13th century. The city is fortified and shows similarities to the city plan of Willemstad, South Africa.

Notable: Its well-preserved sites

Population: 43.104

Location: 20 km north of Tilburg, next to the A59

Loon op Zand is best known for 'De Efteling', which is the largest theme park in the Netherlands – and one of the oldest in the world! The fantasy-themed park's attractions are based on myths, fairytales and folklore.

Notable: The national park 'Loonse en Drunense duinen' is located next to De Efteling

Population: 23.000

Location: 7 km north of Tilburg

Oisterwijk is known for its many forests and fens, and once had a flourishing furniture industry.

Notable: Its natural areas, including 'De Kampina', 'Oude Hondenberg' and the 'Moergestelsebroek'

Population: 26.000

Location: 10 km northeast of Tilburg, to the N65

Hilvarenbeek is the gateway to the region 'De Kempen', which extends far beyond the border with Belgium. The area is characterized by beautiful nature and its ancient forests. Heathland and crop fields provide ideal conditions for cyclists and hikers.

Notable: The largest wildlife zoo in the Benelux: Safaripark Beeksebergen

Population: 15.000

Location: 8 km southeast of Tilburg



Breda

Breda, the capital of the West-Brabant region, is the 9th biggest city in The Netherlands. Breda is a historical yet trendy city within a medieval setting. Lots of buildings stem from the time when the nobles and royals of Nassau family started to reside here.

It's a nice and friendly place where you can find outdoor life at the many cafés and bars around every street corner. The combination of its rich history and many modern-day activities makes Breda an inspiring city! During the course of the last years Breda has grown into a city with around 185.000 inhabitants, 15.500 companies and 100.000 jobs.

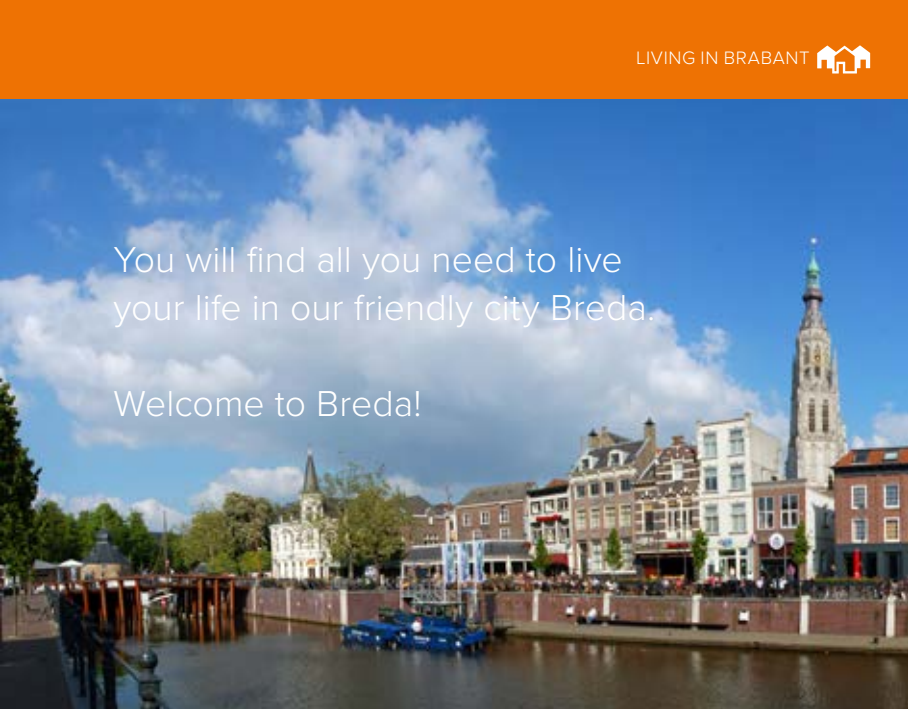
Breda is a prime location for industries as it is located near two of the (most) prominent ports of Rotterdam and Antwerp, and is close to the Belgian border, connecting to all the major highways. Due to the central location of Breda, the area is an interesting place for companies.

A new railway station is recently built and this combined with a connection to the High Speed Link (only 54 minutes by direct train to Schiphol) and you can arrive in Brussels within an hour. This further reinforces the excellent accessibility to Breda.

Our education institutions provide all levels of education. Higher educations such as Avans and Breda University of Applied Sciences rate high in the rankings every year. Avans offers courses in English on the topics Economics, ICT, Technology and Arts & Design. Breda University offers tourism and leisure, digital entertainment as gaming and urban development, logistics and mobility. The only Masters Degree program in Breda is provided by the Dutch Defense Academy for officers in the military army.

You will find all you need to live
your life in our friendly city Breda.

Welcome to Breda!

- 
- Breda enjoys a growing community of expats and internationals.
See Breda Internationals.
 - Important to mention are the award winning universities of applied sciences **Avans Hogeschool** (Avans University of Applied Sciences) and **Breda University of Applied Sciences**
 - The **Dutch Defense Academy** (NLDA), **De Rooi Pannen** and **Curio** (West Brabant Regional Educational Center) are all to be found in Breda.
 - Breda is very proud of the **International School Breda** (ISB), which opened in 2011!
 - The link with the highspeed train.

Population: 184.187 (West Brabant: 721.358)



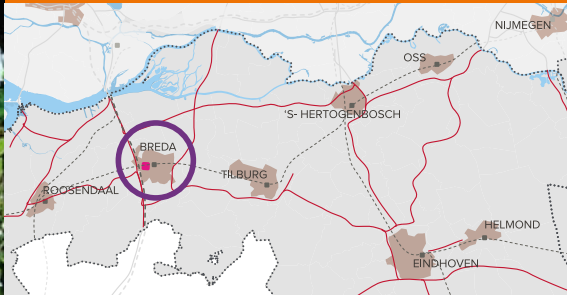
Furthermore, Breda offers vocational education by ROC West-Brabant and De Rooi Pannen within the hotel and tourism industry. And an advantage for internationals living and moving to our city is the International School Breda.

The mix of the many cozy pubs, cafés and restaurants as well as the excellent shopping opportunities make the city a very hospitable and friendly destination for a city breaks. Breda has about 500 shops in the city center. Not only is the amount of shops still increasing, the quality of the shops keeps improving too.

Other special places to visit are the Grote Kerk and the Begijnhof with its herb garden is an oasis of peace within the vibrant city center. Besides, in the heart of Breda you will find the Breda Castle, which now accommodates the Dutch Defense Academy. At the harbor visitors and locals can take a boat tour and discover Breda from the waters. There is a great diversity of hotels were visitors can stay. Breda even has its own 5-star Nassau Hotel.

Leisure opportunities in sports Breda offers hockey, soccer, tennis, ice-skating, mountain biking, baseball, rowing and provides gyms all over. For nature and peaceful surroundings visit the Mastbos and Liesbos forest. We host big events, such as Jazz Festival Breda, Breda Barst, 538 King's Day and Breda Live as well as celebrate Carneval at its best. For sports you can join the Singelloop in October, enjoy a NAC soccer game or run with Wings for Live. In summer every Tuesday Breda has the biggest outdoor picnic festival including concerts, known as Palm Parkies.





It is our pleasure to welcome you to our historical city of Breda. Breda offers excellent shopping opportunities and offers vibrant cafés and bars in every corner of the city center. It also enjoys a great diversity of events, from food, sports, music to arts and cultural festivals. The truth is Breda has been nominated as the best city center of the Netherlands. So join us on the Platform Breda Internationals and get a feeling of the city together with other internationals and organizations. We get together and organize events throughout the year for internationals and families.

The best way to get actively involved is by finding us online on

 **Breda Internationals**
and

 **Breda Internationals Group**
www.bredainternationals.com

Steenbergen was part of the 17th century West Brabant Water Line, and originator of the defence principle of inundation. Notable: The surrounding countryside is an important agricultural area for Dutch food production, especially potatoes and onions.
Population: 23.477
Location: Located between Rotterdam, Breda and Antwerp

Tholen is an island encircled by the Oosterschelde National Park. Notable: Tholen The Roosevelt Information Centre, the Orankekamer Museum and the Watersnoodhuis Flood Information Centre.
Population: 25.421

Bergen op Zoom offers shopping and culinary delights in a historical ambiance. Its old squares and unique monuments tell the story of its rich past that dates back over 800 years! Notable: Its city centre has more than 800 monuments.
Population: 66.237

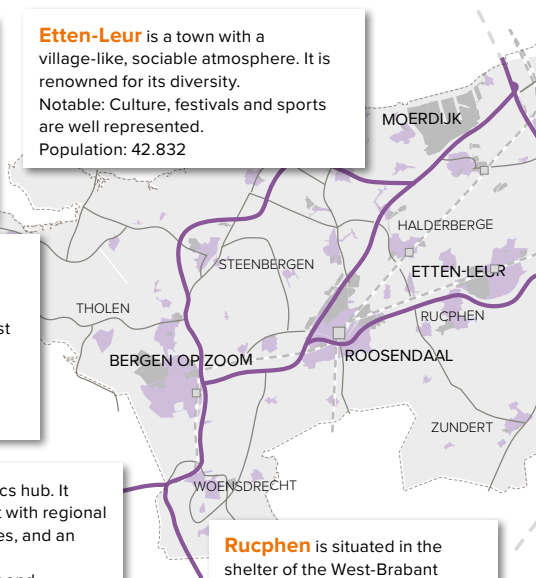
Roosendaal is a major logistics hub. It forms the heart of West Brabant with regional shopping and recreation facilities, and an extensive events program. Notable: Rosada Fashion Outlet and Recreatiepark De Stok
Population: 76.960
Location: Between Antwerp and Rotterdam

Woensdrecht is a cycling municipality, situated in the Brabant Walhalla and the West Brabant cycling region.
Population: 21.682
Location: On the border of Zeeland and Brabant

Moerdijk has a port and industrial area, kilometres of cycle routes and towns with buildings brimming with traditional Dutch atmosphere and history. Notable: Take a boat trip along the Hollands Diep River.
Population: 36.762

Halderberge was founded in the 13th century by monks of the St. Bernard order. Catholicism has provided a legacy of economic and social activity over the centuries. Notable: Historic buildings, beautiful countryside, various housing opportunities and a central position in the region.
Population: 29.531

Etten-Leur is a town with a village-like, sociable atmosphere. It is renowned for its diversity. Notable: Culture, festivals and sports are well represented.
Population: 42.832



Rucphen is situated in the shelter of the West-Brabant urban ring, and is a virtually interconnected area of woods and heathland. Notable: Its cycling and walking routes, and facilities for equestrian sports, swimming and skiing.
Population: 22.276

Werkendam is comprised of Dussen, Hank, Nieuwendijk, Sleeuwijk and Werkendam.

Notable: Discover the industrial decor of one of Europe's largest inland ports which is a vibrant complex of maritime activity.

Population: 26.527

Woudrichem The Land van Altena (Aalburg, Werkendam and Woudrichem)
Notable: Biesbosch National Park is a protected nature reserve and the largest fresh-water tidal region in Europe.
Population: 14.518

Drimmelen is the "front garden of the "Biesbosch National Park."

Notable: Explore the area by foot or bike, or enjoy many water sports.

Population: 26.815

Location: 14 km north of Breda

Aalburg is an attractive place for living and recreation.

Notable: Defence lines, such as the Nieuwe Hollandse Waterlinie, and enjoyable cycling routes.

Population: 13.038

Geertruidenberg became the first city in the county in 1213 when Count William I of Holland granted it city rights.
Notable: Its impressive marketplace gives an impression of its important former trading function.
Population: 21.630

Oosterhout is rurally situated, but only 30-minutes from Rotterdam and Antwerp.

Notable: Splendid parks, the Bussel theatre, and extensive woods

Population: 54.018

Location: North of Breda.

Alphen-Chaam offers peace and tranquility. Nature plays an important role in defining its character.

Notable: Has held the Cittaslow international quality of life certificate since 2010.

Population: 9.924

Location: Southeast of Breda and southwest of Tilburg.

Zundert is surrounded by areas of natural beauty, and offers endless walking and cycling opportunities.

Notable: Has the biggest dahlia parade in the world and is Vincent van Gogh's birthplace.

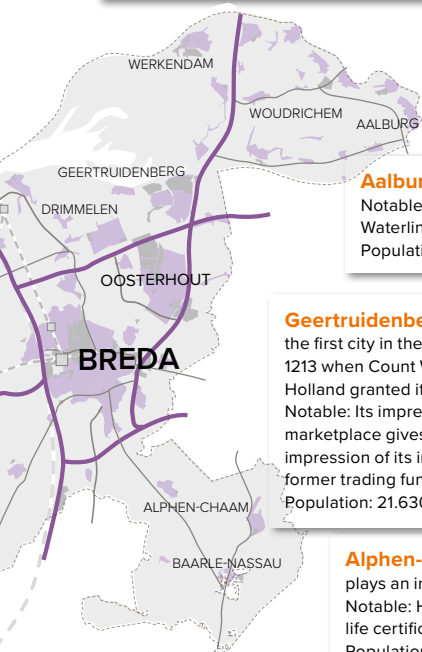
Population: 21.488

Baarle-Nassau offers Dutch exuberance and Flemish hospitality.

Notable: Its complex geographical location includes 30 Dutch and Belgian sections of territory!

Population: 6.611

Location: 19 km from Breda





BREDA INTERNATIONALS

Breda Internationals is a co-creative platform and works together with many people and organizations. Official partners are Avans, Breda University of Applied Sciences, Holland Expat Center South and International School Breda. We also have an advisory board group with 12 enthusiastic international people who care for the city and help to make the right choices and to build a strong and loveable international community. And since November 2019, we officially have an Expat Information Desk at the International School Breda.

Expat Information Desk Breda

Mozartlaan 35, 4837 EH Breda
+31 76 560 7870

Opening times:

Tuesday and Thursday from 10:00-12:00
E-mail: breda@hollandexpatcenter.com

3.5 Banking

A Dutch bank account is necessary for those who are going to live in the Netherlands for some time. A number of banks offer services to private customers, with branches in cities and villages. In general, the opening hours of banks are 09:00-17:00, Monday to Friday. Some branches are also open on Saturday.

Banks offer the following services:

- **Automatic cash dispensers** at banks and around the city
- **Personal and Internet banking**
- **Insurance**
- **Mortgages**

You must go to the bank in person to open a bank account, but it is not always necessary to make an appointment. Simply ask at the information desk to see an advisor.

The following are required to open a bank account:

- **Passport**
- **Proof of address** (confirmation of registration from the Town Hall or a rental contract)
- **A letter confirming employment** (from employer, or a copy of work contract)
- **BSN**

Payment in shops is generally done by debit card or cash, while restaurants frequently also accept credit cards. Payment of household bills is by direct debit, Internet banking or by acceptgiro.



It can be a good idea to keep a bank account in your home country.



MAKING PURCHASES IN THE NETHERLANDS

There are various ways to pay for purchases in the Netherlands:

- A **Pinpas** (debit card) has a Personal Identification Number, issued for use with your bank account. The amount paid is transferred directly from your account to the payee's account. A maximum daily limit can be negotiated with your bank when you open your account. Debit cards are accepted in most shops, restaurants and cash dispensers.
- **Credit cards** are not widely used in the Netherlands. They are generally not accepted in supermarkets, and are mainly used for bigger purchases, and in restaurants, airports and clothing shops.
- **Personal cheques and eurocheques** are not commonly used in the Netherlands.
- All banks offer **Internet banking**, but only some offer this service in English.
- Some banks have **safety-deposit boxes** available to customers (for a fee).
- Dutch banks can arrange an **international money transfer**. You will need to provide your international banking codes (ABA number for the US, IBAN or BIC for European banks), which is printed on your bank statements.
- It is also quite common to use a **contactless payment** method. The embedded chip and antenna enables consumers to wave the card or a mobile telephone over a reader at a point of sale terminal. This payment method can be used for payments of less than € 25 without entering a pin code. For larger purchases, a pin code is required.
- **Apple Pay** is becoming increasingly popular. It is also common to use an app, such as Tikkie, to pay friends/colleagues.

3.6 Taxation

Your employer is obliged to withhold a wage tax from your salary. In most situations this will be sufficient and it is unnecessary to pay anything extra, and no refund will be given.

- The Dutch tax year runs from 1 January to 31 December.
- Your organization will make sure that in February of the next year, you will receive your annual salary statement at your home address or in digital form. This document is important when filing taxes with the Dutch tax authorities, which you may want – or be obliged – to file before 1 April of that same year.

It is required to file a tax return in the Netherlands if you:

- **Have received an aangiftebrief** (invitation) from the Dutch tax authorities to do so. You will receive a form by the Tax Office by post.
- **Have other sources of income** (for example other salaries, savings, investments, etc.). For more information, visit the Tax Office's website: **www.belastingdienst.nl**.

There is financial support available to students. However, the vast majority of these benefits are only available to students from the EU, and it is rare that the financial support will completely fund your time in the Netherlands. Therefore, it is important to ensure that you have enough savings or a job.

Find more information about the rent subsidy, health subsidy and other support options at

www.belastingdienst.nl/wps/wcm/connect/bldcontenten/



Due to legal reasons, the tool and the application are only available in Dutch. Ask someone who understands Dutch to help you!



THE 30% TAX FACILITY

Highly skilled migrants and scientific researchers may be eligible for an advantageous income tax regulation known as the '30% Tax Facility'. The purpose of this facility is to attract highly skilled professionals from foreign countries who have skills and experience that are scarce in the Dutch labour market.

- 30% of income is entirely free of tax for a certain period of time.
- This 30% allowance is meant to cover the extra costs incurred as a consequence of living abroad (so-called 'extra territorial costs').
- An application for the 30% tax facility must be made by the employer and the employee.
- Each case is specific. Discuss your eligibility with your HR Manager.
- Under the 30% tax facility, an employer may provide a tax-free allowance of 30% of the total salary of an employee.
- The effect of the 30% tax facility is that the highest tax rate (52%) is reduced to 36,4%.

The main criteria to be eligible for the 30% tax facility are:

- Salary level
- Education level
- Relevant work experience
- Extra costs linked with being an expatriate may not be compensated tax-free in addition to the 30% tax facility (e.g. housing, flights home, language courses, etc.).

TIP!

Those who have a Search Year Visa and find employment within the specified amount of time, can convert that residence permit into a residence permit for highly skilled migrants. The salary requirement for this conversion is lower than that for other applicants!

3.7 Insurance

Health Insurance

Every adult living in the Netherlands and paying income tax here is legally obliged to have at least basic coverage of health insurance.

- **Children** (18 and under) receive the basic coverage free of charge, and do not need to have their own policy. However, they must be named on the policy of one of their parents, and will receive the same optional coverage as that parent.
- **Students** can get student insurance via the international office of their university.

Types of policies

- **Naturapolis (Standard Policy)**

Bills are paid directly to the health care provider by the insurer, and the insurer can select the health care provider.

- **Restitutiepolis (Refund Policy)**

The bill must first be paid by the customer and claimed back from the insurer. The patient may choose where care is received. The type of policy will affect the premium. The refund type is more expensive.

Own-risk

In 2022, there is a compulsory excess of €385 per year for the basic health insurance package. This means that you will have to pay the first €385 toward your health care costs yourself. This excess applies per person.

There are exemptions: EU citizens who can provide an E106 from their home country can get a treaty policy and will be insured up to the level of Dutch basic coverage. Those with a **European Health Insurance Card (EHIC)** will also have access to Dutch health care.



Private Insurances (Other Insurance)

- **Third-party insurance** is a legal requirement for vehicle use in the Netherlands. **Fully Comprehensive Insurance Coverage** and variants between the two extremes can also be purchased.
- Although not a legal requirement, many people in the Netherlands have **Personal Third Party Insurance**. This covers circumstances where you or your family may accidentally injure a third party or damage their property, such as if a tree falls in your garden and damages a neighbor's house.
- **House (bricks and mortar) Insurance** is usually paid by the owners of furnished rented properties (confirm this with the owner), but tenants will still need contents insurance to cover their personal possessions.
- **House Contents Insurance** covers personal possessions inside the house. Even in furnished accommodation it is normal to take extra insurance for unusual items. Check your insurance policy for details of what is covered.
- In the case of litigation, **Legal Costs Insurance** covers legal fees and provides legal support when needed.

If you already have European Health insurance, or any other insurance that covers you in the Netherlands, and you do not work next to your studies, then you do not need to take out any local insurance! In fact, you are legally not allowed to take out Dutch public health insurance if you are only here to study. If this is your situation, make sure that your insurance from your home country covers you, or you could also consider taking out Dutch private health insurance.



However, you are legally obligated to take out Dutch public health insurance if you:

- do not have an EHIC card, or
- are over the age of 30, or
- work in the Netherlands (this is regardless of your coverage elsewhere. If you are employed in the Netherlands you will need Dutch health insurance).

For more information, go to:

www.zorgverzekeringslijn.nl/english





The following are included under basic coverage:



- Medical care (including your local doctor and medical specialists)
- Medication
- Hospital costs
- Limited dental care (only surgical dental care for adults)
- Equipment
- Pregnancy care
- Ambulance transport

The following are not covered:



- Flu vaccinations
- Basic dental care (children are covered)
- Extended physiotherapy

3.8 Social Security

The Netherlands has a fairly typical European Social Security System in that it is expensive to run, but offers good benefits to those in need. The main principle is that everyone should be able to play an equally active role in society, and some people need help in doing so: the old and disabled, low-income families, young people without qualifications, and minorities.

In general, the following conditions apply:

- The employee must be covered by social insurance legislation in their country of origin immediately prior to their secondment.
- The employee must be a national of one of the countries that has a treaty with the Netherlands: the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Australia, Bolivia, Canada, Chile, Israel, Morocco, Tunisia, Turkey, US, South Korea, Liechtenstein, Iceland, Bosnia, Macedonia, Cape Verde, New Zealand, and Serbia.
- The employee must have an employment contract with the seconding employer (i.e. the employer in the host country).
- The employer in the country of origin remains liable for all costs related to the secondment. This means, among other things, that the employer must arrange for payment of social insurance contributions in the country of origin.
 - A. The secondment may not last more than 12 months. In some cases this can be extended.
 - B. The purpose of the secondment must not be to replace another seconded employee.
 - C. The employer must carry out **substantial activities** in their home country.

Enjoy the great outdoors!



*“Living in the Netherlands
is an ongoing process, getting
better every day!”*

-- Citlali Alonso, Mexico

3.9 Health Care

The Netherlands has good quality health care. Some important things to know:

- **The huisarts (family doctor or General Practitioner) is central in the Dutch health care system.** This is usually the biggest difference to newcomers.
- **Antibiotics and other medications** are prescribed with great reserve. This has resulted in a very low incidence of antibiotic-resistant infections.
- **Tests are not done automatically** and annual check-ups are only part of the basic service when they are necessary. Private clinics offer this service, but they are expensive and are not covered by Dutch insurers.
- **Pregnancy and childbirth** are considered natural conditions. (Pain relief is only available in a hospital.)
- **The relationship between patient and medical services** is constantly changing and responding to individual patient needs. Do not be afraid to ask for the information/services that you want or feel comfortable with. Your insurance company is a good source of information about what is possible and what is not.
- **Family doctors treat** patients for non-surgical problems, and many also perform minor surgical procedures. They can answer most general health questions, and serve as a link with other medical services. On their referral, you can visit a specialist, whom you can choose, provided your insurance company has an agreement with that specialist. (If not, you will have to pay for it yourself.)



- **Register with a doctor** once you know where you will be living. Finding a doctor can be difficult because many doctors have a waiting list. You are entitled to an orientation consultation before deciding which practice you would like to join.
- **Especially in smaller towns**, once you have registered, it can be difficult or near impossible to change doctors.
- **Outside regular hours call the Centrale Huisartsen Post (CHP)** to consult a doctor or a pharmacist.

Emergencies

For emergencies dial 1-1-2. You will be connected to a central operator who will inquire what services are needed and transfer you to someone who can assist you.

Pregnancy and childbirth

Many Dutch women give birth at home, but more are opting to give birth in a hospital. The choice is yours! If you do want to give birth in a hospital, first check that your insurance will cover this.

First-line (primary) midwife

Midwives work according to a strict protocol, and train for four years. You can choose to have your baby in a hospital, under the care of your own midwife. Only with a medical indication do you get referred to a second-line midwife in a hospital. Then you are under the care of a gynecologist, but will mostly be seen by and cared for by the second-line midwife.

Prenatal care is usually provided by midwives (you may be referred by your family doctor), who will support you throughout your pregnancy and during delivery.

Some screenings (blood tests, ultrasounds or amniocentests) are done in specialist centres, but they are not standard.

After delivery in a hospital you are normally sent home relatively quickly. However, you are entitled to **kraamzorg** (home nursing). Remember to register with the Home Care Association or with **kraamverzorgingscentra** (private nurses).

Dental care

Your dentist does not need to be located in your neighborhood. Generally, your dentist will contact you for a check-up every six months, and will perform most routine procedures. Orthodontists and oral surgeons have waiting lists.



Anaesthesia is usually only given upon request, and dental cleaning is often not part of the basic treatment.

Pharmacies and medication

A **chemist** or **drogist** (drugstore) supplies non-prescription medications, baby items, general toiletries, cosmetics, etc.

An **apotheek** (pharmacy) is the only outlet for prescription drugs. Pharmacies also sell other items, such as over-the-counter medicines, vitamins, and special baby foods. They will also provide advice on taking medication.



The Dutch system is rather restrictive. You may find that a prescription is necessary for medication you were able to buy over the counter in your home country.



The easiest time to register with a pharmacy is at the same time that you register with a doctor. Pharmacies have 24/7 coverage, based on the same system as doctors.

Alternative medical services

Alternative medicine is becoming increasingly popular in the Netherlands. The various forms of alternative medicine (manual therapy, acupuncture, homeopathy, chiropractic medicine, traditional Chinese medicine, etc.) are organized in associations.

- **More alternative treatments** are being covered by medical insurance companies.
- **Ask your insurer** for a list of alternative doctors they cover.
- Many alternative medications are **sold in drugstores**.

Homecare

Thuiszorg (homecare) associations provide for all domestic medical services. They are often organized as **kruisverenigingen** (home nursing associations) where you can borrow medical equipment as well as hire nurses. **Baby consultatie bureaus** (health clinics for babies) are often part of these associations. In these clinics every newborn baby and young child is checked regularly by specially trained doctors who provide immunization programs and other pediatric care. The child will be referred to a specialist for specific problems.

Health screening

A nationwide program screens:

- Women ages 30-60 every 5 years for cervical cancer.
- Women ages 50-75 every 2 years for breast cancer.
- Both men and women ages 55-75 for colon cancer.

Screening for other cancers is not routine in the Netherlands.

If you are in a high-risk group (due to family history, previous illness, etc.) you will be monitored and screened regularly, and if necessary, you will be sent to a specialist.

Academic medical centres

For more complex diseases, you may be referred to an academic medical centre.



Certain hospitals have 'super' specialists who all speak English. Interpreters are available in the hospital, and can be present at your consultation. This service must be requested.

Healthcare Insights:

- Life expectancy at birth male/female (years): 80/84
- Child mortality male/female (per 1000 below age 5): 4/4
- Adult mortality male/female (per 1000 aged 15-60): 69/54
- Total health expenditure per capita (Int \$, 2014): 5.202
- Total health expenditure as % of GDP (2014): 10.9

Source: The Global Health Observatory



"Unite with other expats as soon as you arrive and share the experience."

-- Natalia Lutovinova, Russia



TESTED AT EXACTLY
12.00 NOON ON
THE **FIRST MONDAY**
OF **EVERY MONTH**

WHEN ARE THE PUBLIC WARNING SIRENS TESTED?

All over the Netherlands, the public warning sirens are tested at exactly 12.00 noon on the first Monday of every month. The siren sounds for 1 minute and 26 seconds without interruption. This is a test signal so there is nothing to worry about. The sirens are never tested on a national or religious holiday or Remembrance Day, even if they fall on the first Monday in the month.

In an emergency, the siren will sound repeatedly

If the siren sounds repeatedly, it means that there is an emergency of some kind. You may also hear a warning over the public address system or from a loudspeaker van. Follow the instructions and advice of the public authorities.

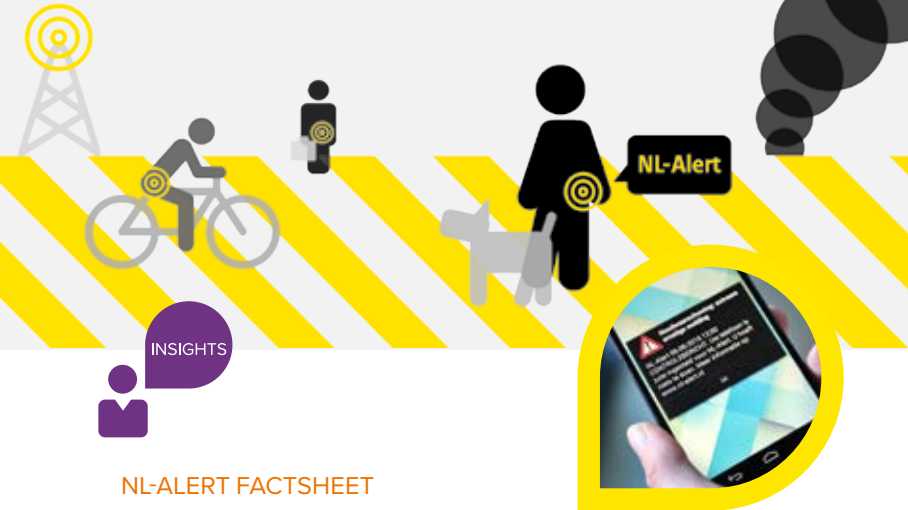
Testing the sirens is important

Public authorities regularly test the sirens to check that they are working properly. It is essential for everyone to know the difference between the test signal and the emergency signal.

If the siren sounds at another time, what should I do?

If you hear the siren at another time, go indoors immediately. Close all doors and windows and turn on the radio or TV and find the emergency station.

Source: www.government.nl/topics/counterterrorism-and-national-security/question-and-answer/public-warning-sirens



INSIGHTS

NL-ALERT FACTSHEET

NL-Alert alarms and informs you when disaster strikes in your vicinity. NL-Alert can be seen on a growing number of digital advertising displays and digital signage at bus, tram and metro stops. You also receive NL-Alert on your mobile phone. Wherever you see NL-Alert, the text message always states what is going on and what you should do. NL-Alert. Immediate information in an emergency situation.

Know what to do

NL-Alert is used in harmful and life-threatening situations, like a big fire, a terrorist attack, or heavy weather. Do you see a NL-Alert on your mobile phone, a digital advertising display or digital signage at bus, tram and metro stops? Follow the advice and inform people in your direct vicinity. That way, they also know what they should do.



How NL-Alert works

The government sends a text message to mobile phones. On your mobile phone, NL-Alert is based on cell broadcast technology. This technology is used to send text messages via the phone masts of all providers. It works in a similar way to a radio signal. You also receive NL-Alert if the network is overloaded. NL-Alert is free and anonymous. Your name and telephone number are not required and thus remain unknown.

NL-Alert can also be seen on digital signage at bus, tram, and metro, as well as digital advertising displays in the immediate vicinity of an emergency. On digital signage at bus, tram, and metro and on digital advertising displays, the message is shown via the internet.

NL-Alert on your mobile phone

All phones made by big name brands are automatically set up to receive NL-Alert. With the national NL-Alert verification message on Monday 2 December, the government, is raising awareness of NL-Alert and the reach of the verification message is being measured. As soon as you receive NL-Alert, your mobile will emit a loud and penetrating alarm sound. In the message you can read what is going on and what you have to do.

Questions?

www.nl-alert.nl



Useful Search Terms

English

Dentist
Doctor
Drug Store/Chemist
Emergencies
Eye Doctor
Fire Station
Furniture Store
Garden Centre
Gas
Gynaecologist
Hospital
Housing – Rental
Immigration Consultants
Insurance Companies
Lawyers
Legal Aid
Notary
Pharmacy
Plumber
Police Stations
Pregnancy
(Real) Estate
Tax Advisor
Tax Office
Utilities Companies
Waste/Garbage

Dutch Translation

Tandarts
Huisarts
Drogist
Spoedeisende hulp
Oogarts
Brandweer
Meubel winkel
Tuincentrum
Gas
Gyneacoloog
Ziekenhuis
Huur huizen
Immigratie consultants
Verzekeringsbedrijven
Advocaten
Bureau voor rechtshulp
Notaris
Apotheek
Loodgieter
Politiebureaus
Zwangerschap
Agent Makelaar
Belastingadviseur
Belastingkantoor
Nutsbedrijven
Afval



*"Eindhoven is...
an industrial city that
was able to change in
the last twenty years,
finding a complete new
identity as a leading
place for technology
and design."*

-- Anna Crosetti, Italy



4. WORKING IN BRABANT

- 4.1 Working in Brabant
- 4.2 Working Regions
Brainport Eindhoven, Hart van Brabant,
Regio van West-Brabant, AgriFood Capital
- 4.3 Search Year Visa

JOB PORTAL FOR INTERNATIONALS IN BRABANT



ARE YOU LOOKING FOR A JOB IN BRABANT?

Check out www.hollandexpatcenter.com/jobs

Via this page you can navigate English jobs that are available in the province of Brabant. Search through vacancies and internships that are being added daily!



4.1 Working in Brabant

There are many international companies with offices located in Brabant. For internationals, these companies are good choices for employment. But first, check to see if your work permit allows for you to work. Depending on your profession, you may need to get your qualifications and certificates verified by the Dutch authorities.

The Dutch corporate environment

In general, common business contact, meetings or negotiations will be quick and efficient. But somethings can be surprisingly different from the way you are used to.

Important to know:

- **The Dutch place great importance** on planning and efficient use of time. This means that you must be on time.
- **Shake hands** before and after meetings.
- **Exchange business cards** during or after a meeting or conversation. There are no fixed rules for this.
- **Time is money** and the Dutch are prudent. Keep presentations short and argumentation brief.
- **Academic or professional titles** are not mentioned in conversations or in general letters, but are included on business cards.
- **The usual Dutch office lunch is short** and simple. It will usually consist of sandwiches with ham and cheese, milk or coffee, and yogurt or fruit as dessert.
- **Once decisions are made**, implementation is fast and efficient.
- **Commitments are taken seriously** and are honored. Deliver on your promises.
- **Spouses are sometimes included in a business dinner**, though business is not generally discussed if spouses are present.



- **Birthdays are celebrated at work.** Take something to share (for example, pie). Your colleagues will take time to enjoy the treat and some coffee!

Dress codes

- The Dutch generally prefer clothing that is **casual, unpretentious, conservative, and subdued.**
- Corporate rules can require a **traditional suit and tie.**
- When conducting business, foreign men may wear a **suit and tie**, though a **sport coat** is also acceptable. Women will wear a **suit or dress.**
- Taking off your jacket in an office is acceptable, but **do not roll up the sleeves of your shirt.** When leaving an office, put your jacket back on.
- Outside office hours, Dutch people like to wear **T-shirts and jeans.**
- For the theater, Dutch usually **dress casually.**

TIP!

- Compliments are offered sparingly, and to say that something is 'not bad' is to praise it.
- Feel free to express your opinion. The Dutch might argue with you, but seldomly take offence.
- The Dutch speak directly. To a foreigner, they may appear abrupt, but it is just their manner of communicating!
- Smoking is prohibited in many areas. If you smoke, always ask before lighting up.
- Do not discuss money or prices, or ask personal questions when you hardly know someone.



4.2 Working Regions

Brainport Eindhoven



The southeast of Brabant, with Eindhoven at its centre, has developed itself from a rural area to a hotspot for IT and high tech. This area, called Brainport Eindhoven, now plays a key role in the Dutch industry and serves as an engine for economic growth. Technologies are developed that change lives. Innovations come to market, that make our futures better, safer and cleaner.

Brainport Eindhoven excels at inventing, developing and integrating world's most complex high tech machines, systems, parts and products at the utmost precision and with unprecedented accuracy. Think, for example, of lithography machines that produce ever smaller chips for 80% of all smartphones on this globe. The next generation chips, faster and even more durable, are based on photonics (light energy) and are currently being developed in Brainport Eindhoven. Other essential fields in which typical Brainport inventions have a meaningful position are healthcare, automotive, food and energy.

Government, knowledge institutes like the Eindhoven University of Technology (TU/e) and companies together created a fruitful soil with an exceptional combination of open innovation, material knowledge, design expertise, system knowledge and integration, human-technology interaction and knowledge about applying data.

Brainport Eindhoven offers lots of room and opportunities for smart people with an open attitude, creative mind, wilful talent and perseverance. People who want to work together with



scientists, designers, inventors and makers. This open and inviting attitude combined with technological progress leads to a dynamic growth of the region. All English speaking tech and IT jobs can be found here: brainporteindhoven.com/work/vacancies/

Great results are achieved because of the combination of a handful global, leading multi-nationals (Philips, ASML, Thermo Fisher Scientific (FEI)) and rapidly acting small and medium sized enterprises working together in living labs and on campuses. In Brainport Eindhoven technology and networks are clustered on campuses in order to create economic value and facilitate business development.

The **Food Technology Park Brainport** in Helmond is set to become a campus operating on the interface of food processing, design and technology. The campus provides space for laboratories, demonstration lines, education, business premises and leisure facilities.

The **Automotive Campus** in Helmond is an important knowledge and innovation centre for the automotive industry, with a strong international focus. The campus is the hotspot for green and smart mobility and (academic) automotive education. The region is a living laboratory, with smart traffic systems, intelligent vehicles that can communicate with each other and their surroundings, hybrid trucks and electric cars.

Brainport Industries Campus is a new campus and going to be the place where the innovative and competitive force of high tech manufacturing accelerates. It is the first location in the world where all parties involved in the high-tech supply chain work closely together on innovation and production in the factory of the future.

INSIGHTS

- Brainport Eindhoven is the **second main economic centre** of the Netherlands.
- It encompasses **21 municipalities** around Eindhoven, which entail companies that provide for more than **436.000 jobs**.
- The region is in the **top 5** of the ScaleUpDashboard, with **65 fastgrowing businesses**.



Hart van Brabant



From the elevated sandy soils near Belgium, to the river beds of the Meuse and Walloon rivers, the **Hart van Brabant** (Heart of Brabant) region straddles a breathtaking stretch of park-like landscapes. It is a region marked by the Burgundian lifestyle of the nine municipalities surrounding Tilburg, along the **Leisure Boulevard** from Hilvarenbeek to Heusden. It is a great place to work, live and enjoy life in a setting reputed for its logistics, health care, leisure economy and aeronautical and industrial maintenance.

It is no coincidence that those sectors are the focal points of **Midpoint Brabant**, an alliance in which administrators of the **Heart of Brabant** have joined forces with businesses and knowledge institutes. Entrepreneurs, educators and government are working together on Social Innovation – an approach to regional development unrivalled in Europe and attracting international attention.

Combining forces through Social Innovation

Social Innovation, as defined in Mid-Brabant, means getting different players to combine their complementary forces and thus achieve far more than any one of them could individually. It is not just an administrative arrangement, but a collective agreement between all parties in the sectors mentioned. The municipalities of Dongen, Gilze en Rijen, Goirle, Heusden, Hilvarenbeek, Loon op Zand, Oisterwijk, Tilburg and Waalwijk are closely involved.

Adding value

Together, these parties are committed to adding social value through innovative product-market combinations designed to increase



employment, prosperity and quality of living. They are committed to collectively giving shape to a sustainable, dynamic region – and to adding value through collaboration with other regions in Brabant, such as the logistics specialists in West Brabant, the high-tech neighbours at Brainport Development Eindhoven (the world's smartest region in 2013), and the Agrofood specialists of Northeast Brabant.

Open to the world

The Heart of Brabant has a dedicated work force made up of people who like to face the world with an open attitude. Most of them speak good English and know what international collaboration means: they operate worldwide, from China and Japan, to Florida and California. Making connections is vital to the kind of Social Innovation that runs through the veins of Mid-Brabant. That's how the region's current high-tech aeronautical and industrial maintenance service sectors evolved out of its former textile industry.

It is also how the region became home to the internationally acclaimed faculties of Tilburg University – such as economics, law and social studies. All of this is characteristic for a community that views living and working together as vital, and that takes pleasure in linking knowledge to production, people to technology, and gamma concepts to beta facts.

Welcome home to the Heart of Brabant

It's no wonder Mid-Brabant is the Netherlands' most visited leisure economy region. Or that it offers international education facilities, like those of the Tilburg International Primary School. This gentle parkland of dykes and dunes is a great place to be, to work and to enjoy life to the fullest. Welcome home to the Heart of Brabant!



Regio West-Brabant



West Brabant; 19 municipalities, over 720.000 inhabitants and around 60.000 companies on 1,740 km². An excellent region to work and live in. For all types of enterprise, the region of West Brabant is ideally situated: halfway between the ports of Rotterdam and Antwerp, with an excellent infrastructure, a well-educated workforce and an innovative business climate.

Logistics

For this and other reasons, the region was voted 'Dutch logistics hotspot nr 1' in 2008, 2009 and 2012 by the logistics sector itself. In 2010, 2011, 2013, and 2016, West Brabant came in second, by a mere few points. For this reason alone, many (inter)national companies have located in the region.

But West Brabant also offers:

- A relatively **low-priced** as well as **varied** supply of commercial **real estate and plots**.
- **Business development programs** within the regional economic spear heads: logistics, maintenance and biobased economy.
- **Plenty of activity**.
- **19 different municipalities**, each with their own characteristics.
- And an **attractive area to live and work in**, that offers an outstanding quality of life.



AgriFood Capital



Developing Northeast Brabant into a leading region in agrifood

That's our mission. In AgriFood Capital industry, public authorities and knowledge institutes collaborate to achieve growth and innovation in agrifood.

Together we are creating a smarter, healthier and more sustainable world for tomorrow. By doing so, AgriFood Capital will become a top class cluster recognized for its future-proof employment market, strong entrepreneurship, high-impact innovations, resilient environment and high quality of life.

From farm to fork

In Northeast-Brabant we face major economic and social challenges. We take on these challenges by making use of the existing strength of the region: the agrifood sector.

Agrifood is the main economic pillar of the economy. Nowhere else is the agrifood complex so complete and of such high quality as in Northeast Brabant. From farm to fork, we have everything we need.

To achieve growth and innovation in agrifood we collaborate with other sectors such as high-tech, transport, construction, pharma, IT, healthcare and education. Together we create an unique and powerful ecosystem in Northeast-Brabant.



AgriFood Facts & Figures Northeast Brabant

- 7.000 agrifood companies
- 52.300 jobs in agrifood
- € 4,4 billion export value
- € 26,2 billion gross regional product
- € 23,6 billion added value

"Coming to the Netherlands, and especially Brabant, to study is a great opportunity to broaden your horizons and experience the highest level of education. It allows you to meet people from all around the globe and gives you different perspectives on the job market."

-- Kacper, Poland



Maintaining and strengthening this agrifood ecosystem is crucial for the future of our region. AgriFood Capital is providing access to knowledge, talent, network and capital and providing a platform for innovations. Together, we convert the economic and social challenges into new (business) opportunities, products and services.

Our Agenda

• Future-proof employment market

In Northeast Brabant, today's innovation determines tomorrow's future. We focus on high-impact innovations in the areas of food & nutrition, health and sustainability. To achieve this, we provide access to knowledge, talent, networks and capital. We create the necessary space, innovation centres and living labs. In the AgriFood Capital cluster, businesses, knowledge institutes and authorities share knowledge and facilities to develop innovative food-related products, concepts and technologies.

• Strong entrepreneurship

From farmer to caterer, the agrifood chain in Northeast Brabant is complete, and of the highest quality. We strengthen our agrifood ecosystem by encouraging the start and growth of companies and attracting new companies to the region. We see endless opportunities instead of boundaries. We invest in access to knowledge and human capital, develop 'breeding grounds for innovation' and encourage collaboration with businesses in other sectors.



- **Resilient living environment**

Climate change, increasing urbanization, the impact of food production on resources and environment, availability of raw materials, and the high standards we set for space to live, work and play demand a resilient environment. An environment that is climate resilient, energy neutral, clean & healthy, easily accessible and sustainably organized. For residents, entrepreneurs and visitors. Northeast-Brabant we are working on a region with prime locations where all the basic facilities are in place to work, study and live well.





Meierijstad: Powerful Together

Our DNA

Entrepreneurial

Meierijstad is an enterprising and economically strong municipality with more than 80,000 inhabitants. Meierijstad is located in the middle of the city triangle of Eindhoven, Den Bosch and Nijmegen. Eindhoven Airport is easily and quickly accessible. Our municipality offers vibrancy, activity, peace and space.

Decisive

We have a culture of thinking and doing. Our inhabitants like to take the initiative. There is a reason why major companies such as Mars, Jumbo, Sligro, Friesland Campina, Agrifirm, Udea and VanderLande, Volvo and the Van Berkel Group are successfully established in this region.

Engaged

The community spirit in our municipality is great. Many of our inhabitants are active volunteers within the community, for example with local sports or culture. Powerful Together, that's our philosophy.

Our strengths

Food

We are the epicenter of the Agri-Food region. From farm-to-table, we have everything you need. A quarter of the food the Dutch population have on their plate comes from within our municipality. From local cafe to Michelin star restaurant, you can fully enjoy the bounty of what is produced in our region. We are also at the



forefront when it comes to innovation. For example, the Together Against Food Waste movement originated in our municipality.

Culture

There is much to enjoy and experience in our municipality in the field of art and culture. National festivals such as Paaspop, 7th Sunday and Fabriek Magnifique are held and organized here. Cultural hotspot CHV Noordkade in Veghel (which provides music, theatre, art, culture and catering) is an important venue, as is the clog producing village of Sint-Oedenrode and the architectural icon, De Glas Boerderij in Schijndel.





Nature

People who love the countryside and nature and will be enchanted by Meierijstad. With rivers and valleys, the Dommel and the Aadal, the Kienehoef regional park and the Schaapskooi in the Wijbosch Broek (Van Gogh National Park) there is much to enjoy for recreation and relaxation. We also have numerous clubs and associations, activities and events in the field of sport and exercise.

Our daily lives

Home

Renting or buying a house? A house in the countryside or in a more urban environment? Would you like to be a short distance from nature and amenities? There is a wide range of housing opportunities in our municipality. Unlike several major cities, there are still opportunities in the housing market in Meierijstad.

Work

Our municipality has more than 45,000 jobs. From seasonal labor to high tech work, we have a demand for all levels of employment. Moreover, due to the presence of local and international companies, there is ample selection in our region.

Life

Meierijstad is a great place to live and work! We have a wide range of facilities. In addition, we are easily accessible by car, bike (via fast bike paths) and public transport (HOV). We also have the Inpat Center, which is happy to help the potential workforce who want to settle in our municipality (www.inpatcenter.nl).



In addition to the rivers and parks our municipality is full of **walking and cycling routes**.



Cultural hotspot CHV Noordkade in Veghel (which provides music, theatre, art, culture and catering) is an important venue



Meerijstad is a great place to **live and work!** We have a wide range of facilities.



4.3 Search Year Visa

Orientation Year Permit for Graduates in the Netherland

Have you successfully finished a Bachelor's or Master's program in the Netherlands? Then you may apply for an Orientation Year Permit for graduates! This permit allows recent graduates from non-EU countries to stay in the Netherlands for a period of up to twelve months, while seeking suitable employment.

Advantages

- During this period, you can seek employment or work without an extra work permit.
- Once employment is found, the permit can be converted into a residence permit for highly skilled migrants. The salary requirement for this conversion is lower than that for other applicants!
- The permit can be collected from the IND or from an Expat Center.

In order to make use of the Orientation Year permit, you must meet certain requirements:

- Graduated from a higher educational institution with a Bachelor's or Master's degree;
- Studied in the Netherlands with a residence permit for the purpose of study;
- Have not previously held a Dutch residence permit to seek and perform work in employment or otherwise;
- Have a valid travel document (for example, a passport);
- Have not given false information or have withheld important information to support any previous applications.



The IND strongly advises you to submit the application within 4 weeks after your graduation!



The philosophy behind Dutch education reflects Dutch society. It aims to encourage students to be open-minded, and to be able to think and to learn in a creative manner.

"Learn Dutch as it will help to integrate and you will feel more part of the community."

-- Bina Champaneria, United Kingdom



5. LIFE LONG DEVELOPMENT IN BRABANT

5.1 Language Courses

5.2 Volunteering



5.1 Language Courses

Nearly all Dutch people speak good English, and if they hear you speak Dutch with a foreign accent, they will probably turn to English immediately! Nevertheless, learning some of the local language is highly recommended. It will help you to settle in, and the locals will appreciate that you have made the effort!

To get official recognition of your Dutch language skills (in order to work for instance) you must follow a course that offers exams within the **NT2** (Dutch as a Second Language) structure. This is administered by the Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture and Science.



Holland Expat Center South organizes Expat Language Lounges where you can speak directly with language school instructors in the region. Check our website for more information!

Language Café at the Eindhoven Library

Learning the Dutch language by putting it into practice, that is the idea behind the language café. Do you find it a bit difficult to have a conversation in Dutch? Does the idea of practicing speaking Dutch with others appeal to you? In small groups (of at most five persons and a volunteer) you will discuss all kinds of subjects. A visit to the supermarket, a parent meeting at school, a birthday visit to a neighbor- everything can be a topic of conversation. Sessions take place on Thursday mornings, in the Eindhoven Library in the Witte Dame, from 10:30-12:00. Join us!



Other cities also have language cafés in their libraries.



"Someone told me to try volunteer work in order to get to know locals. It turned out a very good advice indeed. Not only did I get to know more Dutch people, but I also discovered interesting cultural institutions with which I collaborated."

-- Anna Crosetti, Italy

5.2 Volunteering

There are a lot of opportunities to volunteer in the Netherlands. Many organizations require volunteers, including the food bank, museums, schools, cultural organizations, sports clubs, and Holland Expat Center South!

Volunteering is a platform to learn the language, interact, and can be very rewarding. It is possible to do volunteer work for one or more days per week, or for a fixed number of hours each month. Whether you wish to do volunteer work on a regular basis or just once, the choice is yours!



For volunteer opportunities in Eindhoven, go to:
eindhoven.doetforvolunteers.nl

How did you come across this study at this location? “The TU/e program was promoted at my school in Turkey and I liked its structure and the fact that it is a multidisciplinary study. And the TU/e has a good international ranking.”

How did you prepare for your international move to Brabant? “I was lucky to get 'a scholarship'. To know more about the university and living in Eindhoven, I contacted Turkish students that followed the same study. I found them on the website of the TU/e and via a Facebook-group for international students from the TU/e. They were all very positive, so I had no more doubts.”

Which factor is leading in choosing your first job in the Netherlands? “The job market. Thanks to the education and experience I had here, I'm now able to work in a lot of other countries as well.”

Would like to keep on living in Brabant? “Brabant suits me. It's an open culture ... Also, the infrastructure is very good and in the cities you can do anything by bike. And, very important of course, most of my friends live and work in Brabant as well.”

Any points of improvement? “Only regarding the massive bike theft. I love the fact that you can cycle everywhere; it's practical and good for the environment. But no less than seven of my bikes were stolen already. The lock I have on my current one is more expensive than the bike itself.”

**WHY OTHERS
CHOSE
BRAINPORT
EINDHOVEN**

Karol Hudyka, Poland - International
Business Administration (Bachelor),
Tilburg University



What is the leading factor in choosing your first job in the Netherlands?

“The use of the English language. But learning the Dutch language is also important for me. If you speak the local language, it improves your living situation and you become more part of the society. So a job where both languages are possible would be great.”

Would you like to keep living in Brabant? “I lived in Tilburg for almost three years now and I would like stay here. It’s a small town, but there are many students. You can meet lots of young people in cafes, which the city has quite a lot of. So it’s easy to make new connections. It makes me feel at home here. I don’t think I would like a bigger city, I’m afraid I would lose myself.”

What advice do you have for other international students? “Just do it! When you study abroad, you learn more about different cultures and become more open minded. And once you’ve made that decision, make sure you find a really good educational program, visit the location beforehand so you get a taste of it and always be curious towards your new surroundings.”

What could be improved? “Better communication about public transportation. It’s such a difficult system and not very accessible. It’s also quite expensive. But I would like to emphasize that for the most parts, living in the Netherlands is not as expensive as many people abroad think. You can live and eat here for a good price. But you have to search for it.”



Moving to a new country is an adventure. Among the many questions that you undoubtedly have, are complex as well as simple ones. Where can I do my daily shopping? How can I expand my social network? Is there an expat organization for me to join?



6. PERSONAL AND SOCIAL NEEDS

- 6.1 Dutch Manners
- 6.2 Culture & Society
- 6.3 Shopping
- 6.4 Pets
- 6.5 Religion
- 6.6 Special Events
- 6.7 Expat Networks & Social Clubs



6.1 Dutch manners



Communication:

Many foreigners can find the Dutch direct and abrupt. However, there is no intention to be rude. The Dutch say what they mean and speak their minds!



Addressing people: formal and informal

Dutch people begin to call people by their first name quickly. The Dutch do not use titles when talking to someone. In writing, state the title, only in an official letter. The only exception is the Dutch King and Queen who will always be addressed as His and Her Majesty!

Greeting friends: the 3 Dutch kisses

Friends and family used to kiss each other on the cheeks three times, every time they met. Of course this is no longer the case.





Dining out

When invited, the Dutch make it clear whether you are a guest and therefore do not need to pay. Otherwise, expect to 'go Dutch' and pay for your share, or to split the bill according to the number of diners. A waiter(ess) is beckoned by raising a hand, making eye-contact and calling 'Sir' or 'Madam'.



Tippling

Everyone in the Netherlands receives a basic salary. In restaurants and cafés, give 5-10% of the total bill, if the service was good. Leaving some small change on a restaurant table is a common way of giving a tip to the serving staff. If you are not satisfied, do not give a tip at all! Tips are generally not expected in bars, but are not uncommon. Taxi drivers generally receive a 3-5% tip.



Plants & flowers

Dutch homes are often filled with house plants, and flowers are frequently given as gifts when visiting friends or relatives.



Making a telephone call

When a Dutch person answers the telephone, they will state their first and last name. The name is usually preceded by 'met', which means 'you're speaking with'. Do not make personal calls before 09:00 or after 22:00. On Sundays, do not call before 10:00 and avoid meal times (18:00–19:30).





Making friends

Many internationals find it hard to start making friends in a new country. But there are many opportunities to meet new people! For example:

- Because of their **school activities** and play dates, small children can make it easier for parents to get to know each other.
- **Join a community group or club.** Many neighborhoods have community centres where a lot of activities are organized for the neighborhood's residents. This is a good way to get in touch with the Dutch.
- **Learning some Dutch** will help you in getting to know the Dutch!

Socializing with neighbors

Neighbors can answer questions and help you with practical things. Introduce yourself to your neighbors by inviting them to your house for coffee or tea, or a glass of wine in the evening. In general, your neighbors will in turn invite you over to their house!



Let your neighbors know when you are having a party or renovation, or something else that may cause them any inconvenience. The Dutch value their peace and quiet, so they like to stick to a 23:00 rule: They can complain after 23:00!



INSIGHTS

"The most remarkable, typical Dutch phenomenon I experienced is Carnaval and eating haring. Not because it's raw fish, since I love eating sushi, but because it's not very attractively presented."

-- Meilivia Angelicka, Indonesia

DINNER PARTIES

If you are invited to a Dutch home for a dinner party, observe the following rules:

- **Bring a small gift** for the host/hostess. This can be a bottle of wine, flowers, chocolates, or something from your home country.
- **Be on time.** Arrive no more than 15 minutes late. Don't be too early either because your host might not be ready!
- **Wait until you are served** or asked to serve yourself.
- **Never start to drink immediately.** The Dutch usually raise their glass and drink the first drink together.
- **When you have finished eating,** place your knife and fork side by side at the 15:15 position on your plate.
- **When you have a business meeting** or dinner, you do not have to bring anything, unless it is held at someone's home.
- **If you do not know what to wear,** or if you do not know if and what you have to bring, just ask your host(ess)! You can also ask one of the other invitees for advice.



INSIGHTS

TYPICAL DUTCH FOOD

- **Beschuit met muisjes** are crackers with pink/blue and white balls on them called muisjes (mice). Eaten when a baby is born; blue for a boy and pink for a girl.
- **Stamppot** is a typical winter dish, made of mashed potatoes and vegetables, such as carrots and onions (hutspot), chopped green cabbage (boerenkool) or sauerkraut (zuurkool). Stamppot is eaten with rookworst (smoked sausage) and gravy.
- **Erwtensoup** (pea soup) is eaten when the weather is cold. It is a tradition to eat it after ice-skating!
- **Asperges** (asparagus) are a typical spring delicacy. The Dutch like to eat them with ham, eggs and a hollandaise (melted butter).
- **Hagelslag** is a Dutch product, used abroad only as cake decoration, but the Dutch eat it on sandwiches! They come in many flavors.
- **Kroket** is a crispy crust that is filled with meat. The Dutch eat it with broodje kroket (bread) or at dinner with french fries.
- **Bitterballen** are a smaller round version of the kroket, and are usually eaten as a party snack.
- **Stroopwafels** are two thin waffles with syrup between them that tastes like caramel.
- **Haring is eaten raw!** On markets and in shopping malls you will find stands selling haring with freshly chopped onions.
- **The consumption of dairy products is extremely high**, which according to some scientists accounts for the high average height of Dutch men and women!

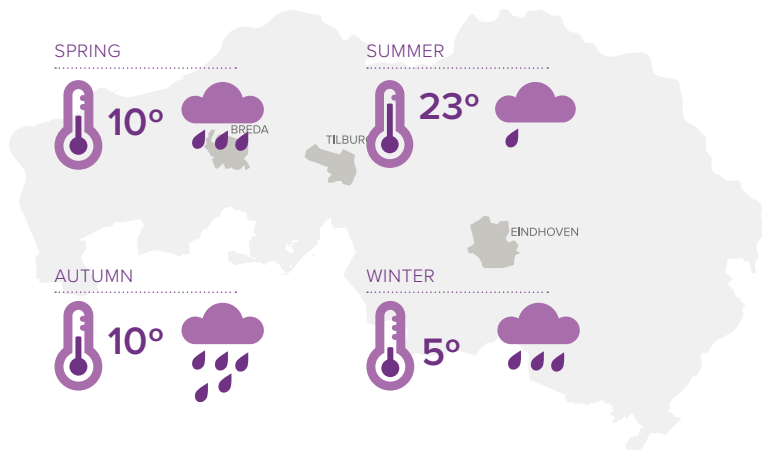


6.2 Culture and Society

- Population is **17.6 million**.
- **Dutch and Frisian** (spoken in Friesland) are the official languages of the Netherlands. Most Dutch people speak good English.
- **The majority of the population** is happy with their quality of life, and the social welfare system is recognised internationally as being excellent.

Climate

The average temperature and rain fall in Brabant, throughout the year (in Celcius).





Dutch food

The Dutch have always been internationally orientated, and nowadays you will find meals from all over the world on Dutch dinner tables, especially among younger people.

The Dutch generally eat three meals a day. Dinner (around 18:00) is the main meal for most people, but some rural families and older people retain the tradition of eating the main meal at lunch. For them, the evening meal is light and often consists of bread, cold cuts, cheese, and a salad.

Value added tax (BTW)

The Dutch standard VAT rate is 21%, and applies to most goods and services. This rate is average in comparison to the rate in other EU member states.

Beverages

A 9% tax rate applies to some items, including food and beverages (excluding alcoholic beverages), water, pharmaceutical products and medical aids for persons and animals, books and magazines, passenger transport, hotel accommodation, cinemas, and zoos. However, the VAT rate for sporting events, theatre visits and musical performances is 19%. A 0% rate applies to exports and intra-community (EU) supplies.

Post offices

There are no longer stand alone post offices in the Netherlands. Instead, postal services are offered inside of certain grocery stores and bookstores.

To mail a letter, find the orange mailboxes, which can be found on some streets. There are two slots in mailboxes: for local mail,



and for the rest of the country and the world. Mailboxes are emptied Monday-Friday after 18:00. Mail within the Netherlands will usually be delivered the next day. Packages can also be delivered to locations, such as grocery stores and other stores.

There are three different types of postage available:

- 1. The Netherlands:** Within the Netherlands
- 2. Europe:** Outside of the Netherlands, but within Europe
- 3. World:** Outside of Europe



There are special **decemberzegels** (December stamps) allow you to send Christmas and New Year's cards at a reduced rate. Use two December stamps to send a card anywhere outside of the Netherlands! Be aware that these stamps are valid during a specific period in November and the beginning of January. For more information, go to: www.post.nl.



To prevent missing a delivery, it is sometimes possible to choose an alternate delivery location, such as a supermarket, as well as a delivery time. This depends on the sender and can be done via an app.

6.3 Shopping

Eindhoven is known throughout the region as a great place to shop. **The Heuvel Galerie**, the **Piazza Centre**, and the **de Bijenkorf** department store are particularly popular. There are plenty of top-end fashion boutiques in the city centre, as well as a range of ethnic and health food stores for those looking for unusual ingredients.



In Tilburg, **Heuvelstraat** (the main shopping street) has a varied range of shops and boutiques. The side streets contain a veritable treasure trove of antique and second-hand dealers, galleries and unique specialist shops. Heuvelstraat leads onto **Pieter Vreedeplein**, a shopping and entertainment centre in the heart of the city.

In addition to this ultramodern square, a new pedestrian area is also being developed. Charming little shops and historical city streets make this a wonderful location for a stroll. There are also large retail centres in **Reeshof** (Heyhoeft), **Tilburg West** (Westermarkt) and **Tilburg Noord** (Wagnerplein).

Weekly markets are set up in different locations around the region, and sell a wide range of food and other items, at lower prices. Markets are popular and are where to head if you want to mix with the locals!

- **Opening hours vary slightly.** Some shops are open from 09:30 to 18:00, Monday to Saturday. More open later (usually at 11:00 or 13:00) on Mondays, and close at 17:00 on Saturday.
- **Shops in larger towns** stay open (until 21:00) one evening each week, for **koopavond** (shopping evening).
- Many shops now open on one Sunday each month for **koopzondag** (shopping Sunday). Some shops are **open every Sunday**.
- **In Eindhoven**, most stores are open in the city centre **every Sunday** from 10:00-17:00.
- **Supermarkets** are usually open Monday to Saturday until 20:00 or 22:00, and until 18:00 on Sundays.



6.4 Pets

Pets are popular in the Netherlands! You will see people walking their dogs around town, and also taking them into stores! The most common pets in Dutch homes are dogs, cats, birds, fish, and rabbits.

Rules regarding dogs

Dogs are only allowed to be off of a leash at a designated **hondenlosloopterreinen**. Dog owners who do not pick up after their dog can be fined.

Dog Tax

Dog owners must pay a dog tax. The amount of tax depends on which city you live and how many dogs you have.

Veterinarians

There are many **dierenartsen** (veterinarians) in the Netherlands.

Animal food

Food for animals can be bought at **dierenwinkels** (pet stores), which also sell treats, games, toys, beds, and other things for pets. Pet food and treats can also be found at most supermarkets.

Finding a pet

If you find a lost or abandoned pet, you can take it to an **asiel** (animal shelter). The people working there will try to trace the original owner or find a new one. If you want to buy a pet, pet stores sell small animals, such as rabbits and guinea pigs. For cats and dogs, contact the local animal shelter or an official breeder.



Olly



Ben



Bruno



Guus



Tyrell

TIP!

De **dierenambulances Brabant Zuid-Oost** (animal ambulances for Southeast Brabant, including Eindhoven) transports sick, injured and lost animals, to a near by shelter, veterinarian or animal hospital. If you see an animal that needs emergency care in Eindhoven, call them at 0900 - 112 0000. They are available 24 hours a day, seven days a week.

TIP!

Ik zoek baas!

is a website where you can find pets who are up for adoption! www.ikzoekbaas.nl

Dog obedience school

There is a number of **hondenscholen** (dog obedience schools) and **hondenuitlaatservices** (dog walking services) throughout the region.

Boarding kennels

When you go on holiday, you can leave your pet with a neighbors, a friend, or at a **dierenpension** (boarding kennels).



Pepper

"Taking your dog for a walk is a great way to get to know your neighborhood and your neighbors! When we moved to a new neighborhood I met many of my neighbors while walking my dog, Pepper!"

-- Olivia van den Broek-Neri

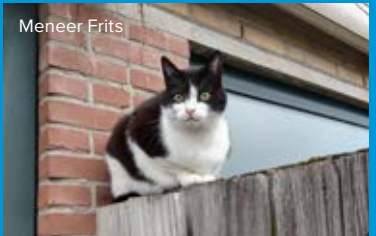
PERSONAL & SOCIAL NEEDS



Harvey



Harrington



Meneer Frits



Max



6.5 Religion

The Netherlands is a tolerant nation, and every individual has the right to practice their religion or conviction. Traditionally, Brabant was strongly Roman Catholic, but during the second part of 20th century, a rapid secularization took place in the province, as it did in the rest of the country. Although there has been a big decrease in the number of people who attend church, the traditions are still part of the culture. For instance, Carnaval, which takes place five days before Ash Wednesday. Today, there is a growth in the number of residents who practice Islam and other religions. The following serve the English-speaking community. Of course there are also services in Dutch, which also welcome internationals!

Protestant **Trinity Church Eindhoven** (TCE) is an English-speaking, international church that is part of the Anglican (Church of England) Diocese in Europe. **De Pracht 1, Waalre** ● www.trinitychurcheindhoven.org

International Baptist Church (IBC Eindhoven) is a multi-denominational congregation. **Het Lichtpunt, Geestakker 546, Eindhoven** ● www.ibc-eindhoven.nl

Victory Outreach Eindhoven (Christian-Pentecostal) **Hoogstraat 384, Eindhoven** ● victoryoutreacheindhoven@gmail.com

A strong presence of the Holy Spirit and a welcoming international community gather in a place where you can feel at home.

Polish Church, St. Maximiliaan Kolbe parochie: St. Laurentiuskerk, **Ginnekenweg 333, Breda**. ● +31 (0)76 565 5433; **Mariakerk** **Mariaplein 1, Breda**. ● +31 (0)76 565 2260

Victory Bible Church International, **Tweeschaar 125, Breda**.
● +31 (0)6 261 140 94



"We are an international Catholic community made up of working people, students and other expats and locals in Eindhoven. We welcome anyone who wants to join us and feel part of a big family who strongly believes in showing love and respect to each other. We're always happy to welcome guests and new members to our community. We meet to celebrate the Holy Mass in English every Sunday at 12:30."

● www.englishmasseindhoven.nl  English Mass Eindhoven



City Life Church Breda, Nassausingel 26, Breda ● www.clcbreda.nl

Jefta Intercultural Church, location Graaf Engelbecht, Ganzerik 3, Breda. ● kantoor@jefta.org

CEC, Chinese Christian Evangelical Church Seminary International. Goeseelsstraat 30, 4817 MV Breda. ● www.emsionline.org
● emsibreda@gmail.com

International English Mass in St. Michael Church, Hooghout 67 in Breda. Every Sunday at 13.00 ● info@augustinusparochiebreda.nl

Winners Church International Breda, Steendorpstraat 2, Breda.
● +31 (0)6-50241151

Muslim Fatih moskee Eindhoven, Willemstraat 67, Eindhoven
● +31 (0)40-245 1944 ● www.eindhovenfatihmoskee.nl

Anwar-E-Madinah Kastelenplein 1691, Eindhoven
● +31 (0)40 251 3089 ● www.anwar-e-madinah.nl



Parochie Christus Koning welcomes the International Catholic Community living in Veldhoven and Meerhoven!

Kapelstraat-Zuid 18, Veldhoven ● www.christuskoning.nl



City Life Church Tilburg offers an inter-denominational Christian community who speak English and Dutch. Services are on Sunday at 10:00 and 12:00 at Club Smederij (spoorzone).

● info@clctilburg.nl ● www.clctilburg.nl ●  [@clctilburg](https://www.facebook.com/clctilburg)

Stadskerk040 is a modern Christian fellowship in Eindhoven whose services take place in Eindhoven's landmark: Evoluon. On Sundays, the service is translated into English. ● stadskerk040.nl/en

6.6 Special Events

The region hosts many annual events. Among the most popular events is **Carnaval** (held the five days before Lent every year) when the entire region lets its hair down, dresses up in crazy costumes, and celebrates in a festival of music and color with events for all ages!

King's Day

Koningsdag (King's Day) is on 27 April and celebrates King Willem-Alexander's birthday. On this day, the country turns orange as everyone wears orange clothing! A tradition is that the royal family visits someplace in the Netherlands and participates in local activities. In 2022, the royal family will visit Maastricht. There are also many festivities throughout the country, as well as flea markets in the city centres.



On King's Day, make sure that you wear something (or everything) orange!



New in town? Don't know what's hapening on campus? Trying to connect with new people? Looking for sports buddies or someone to meet-up with for a coffee?

enjoyn is your place to go. Discover what's happening, socialise, or find help in difficult times.

A community platform built by students, for students:

Discover

special lectures
parties
borrels
student societies
culture events
job fairs
and more

Connect with

(sports) buddies
mentors
clubs
interest groups
friends



Support

life can be rough
at times.
enjoyn shows
you where you
can get support
when you need it





PERSONAL & SOCIAL NEEDS

iesn

INTERNATIONAL EXCHANGE
ERASMUS STUDENT NETWORK



TILBURG INTERNATIONAL CONNECTION

**FRIENDS FROM
AROUND THE GLOBE**



**MANY TRAVELING
OPPORTUNITIES**



PARTIES IN OUR BAR

**Carpe
Noctem**



**ALL THIS,
FOR JUST €45 PER YEAR!**



WHAT IS TILBURG?



Tilburg is a lovely little city in the middle Brabant with a bustling student population. Approximately 1 in 7 citizens are students, and everyone is very friendly towards international visitors. Most people speak English and can assist you whenever you need help!

**Are you wondering what you can do in Tilburg?
We suggest giving these activities a look!**





● Breda Internationals

is a community group for internationals living in and around Breda. This group is designed for expats who come to work and live in the city of Breda. We also welcome international students, as well as Dutch international-minded people. With a great amount of internationals coming from all over the place to our city, we want to make sure everyone feels welcome and at home. This group is there to support you with finding information, events and friends in the city.

We organize diverse events for families and professionals, and also create social events, such as Meet & Greets and we combine this with existing events in the city, to get you closer to our local city lifestyle. Also, to help you on the way to understand the Dutch system, we create workshops on for instance Taxation, Housing, Volunteering, etc. Based on your needs we will adapt our program every year!

Please take the initiative and use this platform to ask any type of questions, because you are not alone and many other internationals are there to help you. Or give relevant information, tips and events that you have and share them with us on our platform.

More information:



Breda Internationals

E-mail: breda.international@breda.nl



Get in touch with us and we will add you to our WhatsApp group!





Are you being discriminated against?

Every person in the Netherlands must be treated equally in equal circumstances. That is the first sentence of the first article of the Dutch constitution. Discrimination on the grounds of religion, belief, political opinion, race, gender or any other ground whatsoever is not permitted. If you are a victim of discrimination or have witnessed to discrimination you can turn to RADAR for help.

If, for instance, you are refused an apartment because you do not have the Dutch nationality, or if you experience problems with your employer because of your pregnancy, you can ask RADAR for help. You can also file a complaint at RADAR when you are refused entry to a club and you suspect this has to do with the colour of your skin.

Another example where RADAR can help is when a shop or public service is not accessible for people with a disability. RADAR's specialised employees will give you personal advice. We can mediate between you and, for instance, your employer or landlord. We can also assist you in taking legal steps. RADAR's support is free of charge.

RADAR is an independent antidiscrimination service that operates in more than 60 municipalities in the Netherlands. RADAR is committed to supporting anyone who experiences discrimination or unequal treatment in whatever way. RADAR focuses on equal treatment by means of research, policy advice and workshops and training for professionals.

RADAR has offices in Eindhoven, Tilburg, 's-Hertogenbosch and Rotterdam. **You can contact us** +31 (0)40 249 1444, by info@radar.nl or visit www.radar.nl.



vóór gelijke behandeling
tegen discriminatie



6.7 Expat Networks & Social Clubs

TIP!

Joining a club or organization is a great way to meet new people who can also offer you good advice!

There are a number of groups in the region especially for expats and their families.

- **Mums and Toddlers** offers various activities for mothers with young children in and around Eindhoven.
 - www.mumsandtoddlers.org
- **North American Women's Club (NAWC)** organizes monthly potlucks, a Harvest Festival for children, a Thanksgiving dinner, and a 4th of July barbecue.
 - www.nawceindhoven.com
- **The Indo-Dutch Association** is for Indian people living in the Eindhoven area. • indodutch@hotmail.com
- **International Women's Club Breda (IWCB)** provides a network of companionship and support for women in the Breda area.
 - www.iwcbreda.nl
- **Tilburg International Club (TIC)** welcomes and supports its international members by providing information, events and social networking opportunities.
 - www.tilburginternationalclub.com
- **Polish Professional Women in the Netherlands** is a platform inviting Polish professional females living and working in the Netherlands.
 - polishprofessionalwomen.com
- **Centro Latinoamericano de Orientación** is a Spanish and Latin American Hispano-Americana association.
 - www.cloeindhoven.nl



Radio 4 Brainport: Expat Radio Welcomes You!

Radio 4 Brainport is an English language community radio service run by volunteers, broadcasting 24/7 international popular music and items about a variety of topics. From first-hand expat experiences, contributions by internationals to tips for a day out, or explaining habits of the Dutch. Hear interviews on these topics throughout the day!



Longer, in-depth interviews can be heard in special programs, such as **Tea-Talk with Karishma and Supriya**, whose primary aim is to reach out to international residents. The hosts invite guests who talk about their career, education, and lifestyle. Guests are also asked what about their favorite tea and music; it is the first in the region to include Bollywood and Hollywood songs! The talk show presents expat-related topics, highlighting innovation, which is the hallmark of the Brainport region.



Hosts of **Tea-Talk**: Supriya Vij and Karishma Vij
Fridays at 20:00

The station also provides local and (inter) national news, weather, and detailed traffic information.

Listen to Radio 4 Brainport on
DAB+ digital radio AM 747 kHz, or via
the website radio4brainport.org.



Radio 4 Brainport is also
looking for volunteers!





"Biking around is one of the most exciting things Eindhoven has to offer and one of my favorite activities in the region. You can visit another city, enjoying the beautiful paths on the way. I suggest going to Nuenen: the trip is adorable and visiting Vincentre and Van Gogh Village is totally worth it."

-- Leticia Batista, Porto Alegre, Brazil





7. TRANSPORT

- 7.1 Bicycles
- 7.2 Public Transport
- 7.3 OV-Chipkaart
- 7.4 Airports
- 7.5 Taxis
- 7.6 Driving



7.1 Bicycles

A network of bicycle paths covers the entire country, and makes getting around by bicycle convenient and relatively safe. Bicycling is also an enjoyable and healthy way to get around!

- It is not required to wear a helmet.
- It is illegal to be intoxicated while cycling. (You can lose your driver's license.)
- Always watch out for motorcycles and scooters.
- New and second-hand models are widely available.
- Those seen using their mobile phone while cycling can get a € 95 fine.



1. **Always lock your bike!** Invest in a good lock and use it to lock your bike against something, each and every time you leave it.
2. **Make your bicycle stand out!** Decorate it (with flowers and/or painting it in a distinctive color). Bicycles that stand out are less likely to be stolen.
3. **Do not purchase a bicycle from someone on the street!** Most likely, the bike is stolen.

7.2 Public Transport

The Dutch public transport system is good, and many people use it every day. The country is small, and with the exception of the major rivers that cross the landscape, has few significant barriers to land transport systems.

- For travel advice on public transportation, go to **www.9292.nl**.
- For bus information, go to **bravo.info/bus/**.
- For train information, go to **www.ns.nl**.



Trains

Trains are run by the national **Nederlandse Spoorwegen** (NS-Dutch Railways), and run between all major Dutch cities. There are innercity trains that travel between cities, and sprinters that travel between villages.

A bicycle ticket costs € 7,50 and allows you to take your bicycle on the train throughout the Netherlands, from 09:00 and 16:00, and between 18:30 and 06:30. Your bicycle must be placed in the specially designated places in the train.

Cats and small dogs can travel on the train free of charge. Guide dogs (including ones being trained) are also permitted to travel free of charge, when they are recognisable as an assistance dog. Larger dogs must have a dog ticket, which costs € 3,30.

Buses

The region has extensive urban bus networks that connect outlying districts and nearby villages with their city centres. Buses in Eindhoven usually run up to four times per hour, and then after 18:30 twice per hour. Buses to and from villages can run less frequent. It is currently not possible to purchase a ticket on the bus.



When waiting at a bus stop, you must raise your hand to alert the bus driver to stop! You must also alert the bus driver when you would like to get off of the bus.

**TIP!**

The **Dalkorting Noord-Brabant** subscription gives you a 40% discount on travel on Hermes and Arriva buses in Brabant after 09:00 on Monday-Friday, and all day on weekends and holidays. It costs € 13,40. There is also a special discount for persons 4-18 and 65 years older. Get more information at www.hermes.nl/en

INSIGHTS

Since December 2016, all 43 public buses in the Brabant cities of Eindhoven and Helmond have been electrically powered, and form one of Europe's largest zero-emission bus fleet in public transportation!

TIP!

The **Dal Voordeel** subscription costs € 5 per month and gives you a 40% discount on train travel during off-peak hours and on the weekend. It can be used with up to three travel companions. Monthly and annual season tickets are also available. You can also get a Group Ticket for travel during off-peak hours for 4-7 persons.



7.3 OV-Chipkaart

The **OV-Chipkaart** (OV-chip card) is the means of payment for public transport in the Netherlands. The size of a bank card, the card contains an invisible chip, and can be loaded with credit. Make sure that you have scanned your OV-Chipkaart before boarding the train, bus or tram, because this can be checked during your trip!

Types of cards:

1. Personal: Like a personal ID card. It has your photo on it and personal information, such as name and birthdate. It is non-transferable, and can hold travel products based on the age of the holder (e.g. students or senior citizens). When lost or stolen, it can be blocked within 24 hours. It costs €7,50.

Purchase it online at www.ov-chipkaart.nl.

2. Anonymous: This card is transferable between persons.

However, only one person can use it at a time. It costs €7,50 and credit can be added to it as needed. When lost or stolen it cannot be blocked.

Purchase it at the service desk at the train station.

3. Single-Use OV-Chipkaart: Made of stiff paper, these have replaced the old paper-tickets. They can only be used for simple travel products (single, return, or a 1-day pass) and are meant to be thrown away after use. These cards cost €1, in addition to the regular price of the trip. (Some exceptions apply.) This option is best for tourists or occasional travelers.

Purchase it at an NS-ticket machine.



Check in and check out

- Hold your OV-chipkaart up to the OV logo on the card reader. You will hear a beep and see a green light. On the screen text will appear such as, 'Goede reis!' (Have a nice journey!), and a sort of surety money is deducted from your credit balance.
- Do not check out if you change trains during the same trip.
- Do check out if you change means of transportation (bus to train).

At the end of your trip, check out in the same way. Hold your OV-chipkaart up to the OV logo on the card reader. Again you will hear a beep. The real cost for the trip is now deducted from your credit balance.

Your OV-chipkaart must have a minimum amount on it, which is dependant on your method of transport (bus/tram/train). The usual amount to board a bus is € 4, but it can be more, depending on the bus line. When in doubt ask someone! If your balance is not enough, you will be required to purchase a one-way ticket.



TIP!

If you do forget to check out, you can apply for a refund via www.ov-chipkaart.nl.



7.4 Airports

Eindhoven Airport is served by several low-budget carriers, and has direct flights to and from a number of European cities, as well as Egypt, Morocco, Turkey, Israel, and Russia. For further destinations, you must fly from Amsterdam's Schiphol Airport; Düsseldorf, Germany; or Brussels, Belgium.

Eindhovenairport.nl/en



Bus 400 offers a direct bus connection between Eindhoven Airport and Eindhoven Centraal Station.

7.5 Taxis

Taxis can be recognized by the lit 'taxi' sign on their roof, and their blue license plates (most Dutch vehicles have yellow plates). They cannot be hailed on the street, but there are taxi stands at most train and bus stations, and by hotels. To have a taxi pick you up from your home or office, phone a local company.

7.6 Driving

With a network of highways connecting major towns, the road system makes getting around easy. However, during rush hour (08:00-09:30 and 16:00-17:30), roads can become very busy.

Nevertheless, except when there are major disturbances, such as road accidents or construction work, traffic usually flows smoothly and it is possible to cross Eindhoven in about 30 minutes. Information about importing and registering a vehicle, and buying a car, can be found in **Chapter 2: Moving to Brabant.**



Vehicle purchase tax (BPM)

The purchase, lease or rent of vehicles and motorcycles might be subject to a special tax (the so-called 'BPM'). The amount of BPM due depends on the Dutch list price and eco-friendliness (CO₂ emission) of the vehicle.

Road rules

Dutch road rules conform to most European regulations:

- **Drive on the right-side** of the road and overtake on the left.
- Unless otherwise posted, vehicles **coming from the right have priority**.
- **Mobile phones** may only be used with a **hands-free system** while driving. Merely holding a mobile phone in a moving vehicle is considered an offence.
- **The maximum speed** in towns is 50 km/h, outside urban areas is 80 km/h, and the maximum on motorways throughout the Netherlands is 100 km/h. (Except where otherwise stated.)
- **Bike paths** run along side most roads and around roundabouts. When turning (or leaving a roundabout) **always** look out for bicycles crossing your path. In most cases, bicyclists have the right of way.

Parking

- **In metered parking areas (P zone)**, purchase a parking ticket form from a machine (found on the side of the road). Display your parking ticket in the front of your car's window.
- **In parking garages**, paying machines are located by the stairwells, and can be paid in cash or with a Pinpas. Submit your paid parking ticket into a machine before exiting the parking area.
- Parking your car in a **spot for disabled people** can result in a €360 fine.
- **'Park and Ride'** facilities are located near main train stations.
- There are **apps** that allow you to pay for your parking **via your mobile**.

Cristian Cîreașă, Romania

- Environmental Science for Sustainable
Energy and Technology (bachelor),
Avans Hogeschool Breda

avans
university of
applied sciences

Was it difficult for you to find a job upon graduation? "Fortunately, I had performed well during my graduation internship which helped me to receive a contract upon graduation."

What is your current position? "Currently, I am an Environmental Consultant at Witteveen+Bos in Breda. Luckily, the transition from what I've learned during my Bachelor to the working environment was effortless, since the education system is tailored to meet the needs of the job market."

How do you like working in Brabant? "I am still positively surprised by the hospitality and goodwill of the people in the Netherlands and even more so by the people from this region, Brabant. Looking back, I can say that I made the right choice for my personal and professional development, and I would not trade Breda with any other place."

What has surprised you about the Netherlands? "Everyone wants to improve the world they live in, with quality as a top priority. This creates a well-functioning society which enables the country to be at the forefront of innovation and progress."

What advice would you give other international students who want to come here? "Learning the language as soon as you arrive, especially if you eventually plan on staying. The fact that everyone speaks English very well does make it harder to learn the language, but in the end, you will profit from it. At the same time, be aware of the cultural difference, which is very well depicted by two famous Dutch sayings: "If you don't ask, you already know" and "If you say nothing, you agree with what's been said".



Brabant is a great place for arts and leisure. Theatre performances are sometimes in English, films are nearly always shown in their original language, and you can dance or listen to music in any language you like! For those who prefer the great outdoors, the countryside in the region is surprisingly green, and is a lovely area for those who like to bike, walk, or simply drink a beer on a picturesque terrace on a small Brabant village market square.





8. CULTURE & LEISURE

- 8.1 Holidays in the Netherlands
- 8.2 Music
- 8.3 Theatre & Ballet
- 8.4 Cinema
- 8.5 Museums
- 8.6 Van Gogh Brabant
- 8.7 Public Libraries
- 8.8 Nature
 - De Groote Heide, Valkenswaard
- 8.9 Sports
- 8.10 Trip Ideas Outside of Brabant



INSIGHTS





8.1 Holidays in the Netherlands

The Netherlands has a Christian background, and therefore celebrates many Christian holidays. On those days, companies and schools are closed.

Dutch National Holidays in 2022

- **New Year's Day** (Nieuwjaarsdag): 1 January
- **Easter & Second Day of Easter** (Eerste & Tweede Paasdag):
17-18 April
- **King's Day** (Koningsdag): 27 April
- **National Remembrance Day**/ Dodenherdenking: 4 May
(not an official holiday)
- **Liberation Day** (Bevrijdingsdag) 5 May (holiday every 5 years,
next in 2025)
- **Ascension** (Hemelvaartsdag): 26 May
- **Whitsun and Second Day of Whitsun** (Pinksterdag en Tweede
Pinksterdag) 5-6 June
- **Sinterklaas** 5 December (not an official holiday)
- **Christmas and Second Day of Christmas** (Eerste Kerstdag
en Tweede Kerstdag): 25-26 December

School holidays

Children get a lot of days off from school in the Netherlands! There is also a ruling that a school is allowed a number of free days to allocate at their discretion. It is therefore possible that you could have two children in different schools with different days off! To avoid major traffic jams during holiday periods, school term dates vary by region, and depending on the type of school. Schools are divided into three holiday regions:

- **North, Central and South**
- **Brabant** belongs to the **Southern region**.



2021-2022 School Holidays in Brabant

- **Autumn Holiday** (Herfstvakantie): 25 - 29 October 2021
- **Christmas Holiday** (Kerstvakantie): 23 December 2021 - 7 January 2022
- **Spring Holiday** (Voorjaarsvakantie): 28 February - 4 March 2022
- **Easter** (Pasen): 18 April 2022
- **May Holiday** (Meivakantie): 25 April - 6 May 2022
- **Ascension Day Holiday** (Hemelvaartsdag): 26 - 27 May 2022
- **Whitsun** (Pinksteren): 6-7 June 2022
- **Summer Holiday** (Zomervakantie): 25 July - 2 September 2022

8.2 Music

There are music performances offered in many places, and of many different types. Several bars and cafés around the region host regular musical events by lesser-known artists, many of them local acts. Some of these events are free to attend.

- **Muziekgebouw Frits Philips Eindhoven** offers a wide selection of classical and world music concerts, and an International Music Master Programme. Brabants Orchestra performs at the Muziekgebouw on a regular basis.
- **De Effenaar** is Eindhoven's top venue for pop, rock and dance music. Internationally famous bands and artists often play there.
- **013 Poppodium** is a renowned popular music venue in Tilburg that regularly features national and international acts, festivals, cabaret and the 'Metal Matinee'.
- **PaRaDox** was founded in Tilburg by a number of local jazz musicians to provide a showcase for alternative modern music genres. Performances are notable for a particularly relaxed and informal atmosphere.



- **De Link** presents unconventional chamber music in Tilburg, with a special focus on contemporary composers.
- **MEZZ** is a podium for live pop music and dance in Breda.

8.3 Theatre & Ballet

- **Parktheater Eindhoven** offers a wide range of performances, with a focus on dance and ballet, popular music and theatre, and occasionally opera. They offer an international program. They also present an annual Winter Circus.
- **Theaters Tilburg** includes the Schouwburg, Concert Hall, Studio and the Filmfoyer, offering a broad range of live theatre, music and film. The professional program includes more than 350 performances and concerts, and 750 film screenings each year.



- **Theater De NEW Vorst** is a vibrant theatre in Tilburg's city centre that presents theatrical and dance performances for adults and children. Many productions by local and regional companies have their première here.
- **The Kunstbalie** actively promotes all forms of artistic expression, including music, puppetry, photography, art and film.
- Several towns have their own smaller, but equally charming theatres.
- **International Theatre Collective Eindhoven** produces annual theatre performances played by internationals and nationals on the basis of current themes under the guidance of a professional artistic staff. Professional and amateur actors are welcome. If you are interested in auditioning for a production, send an email to **itceindhoven18@gmail.com**.

8.4 Cinema

Cinemas in the region offer mainstream movies as well as art-house productions, and even movie-theatre performances in smaller venues. Most films are shown in their original language with Dutch subtitles. Foreign films aimed at younger children are shown in two versions:

- the original (subtitled) version
- a version dubbed into Dutch



Make sure to specify which version of the movie you want to see when buying tickets for a children's movie.



NATLAB

For more information:
www.natlab.nl/english

Natlab

The Natlab is a culture meeting place for contemporary arts.

Theatre/ballet - They offer a wide range of performances in collaboration with Parktheater: theatre, dance and cabaret.

Cinema - Natlab screens English movies and movies from all over the world with English subtitles. Enjoy the latest movies, from Oscar-winning movies, to low-budget documentaries, to costume dramas and kid's movies.

Activities for Children - Every school holiday Natlab organizes activities for kids.

8.5 Museums

- **The Van Abbemuseum contemporary art museum** enjoys an enviable reputation within the art world. Its vast collection includes works by Picasso, Chagall, Kandinsky, El Lissitzky, Mondriaan and Appel.

Exhibitions are held on a regular basis. The Van Abbemuseum also contains an auditorium, a bookshop, a unique multimedia library, and an airy restaurant with a terrace overlooking the Dommel River.



Photo: Avik



Photo: Jayeeta

These photos were taken by Jeyeeta and Avik who joined our Meet & Greet 's-Hertogenbosch and Meet & Greet Helmond events in the autumn of 2018!



Photo: Jayeeta



Photo: Jayeeta



Photo: Avik



Photo: Avik

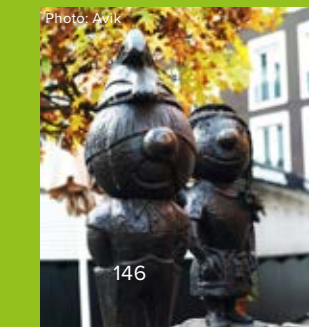
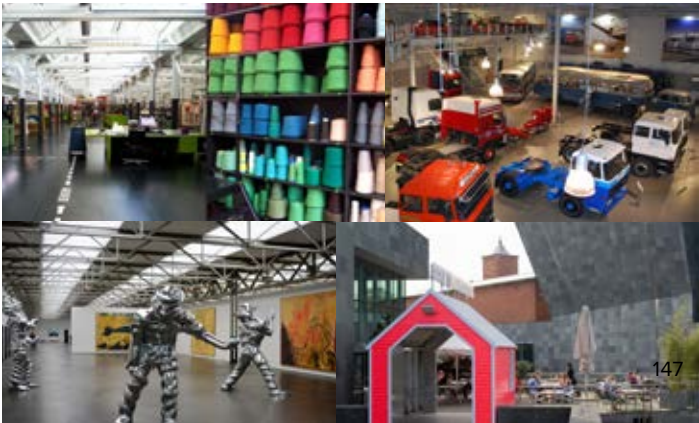


Photo: Avik



- **De Pont Museum of Contemporary Art** is one of the most popular art museums in the country. Founded in 1992, it exhibits works by Dutch and international artists. The museum is housed in a former wool mill that has been converted to provide an ideal showcase for contemporary art.
- **Textiel Museum** not only houses an extensive collection, but is also a 'working' museum, with historic production machinery still in daily operation. There are four main exhibits: textiles technology, industrial heritage, textile-related art and textile design.
- According to the philosophy of the **Stadsmuseum**, a museum museum does not need a permanent home: 'Not everything has to take place at a fixed location.' This relatively new museum shows the past, present and future of Tilburg.

Other museums to check out, include the **Eindhoven Museum**, the **Philips museum** and the **DAF Museum**.





Welcome to Vincent van Gogh's Province of Birth.

Vincent van Gogh (1853 - 1890)
was born and raised in Brabant!
It is also where he produced his first
masterpiece, 'The Potato Eaters'.



The world-famous Van
Gogh-Roosegaarde
Cycle Path was
inspired by Van
Gogh's 'Starry Night'
painting. Visit it
after dark when the
thousands of tiny
stones light up!





If you plan to visit a lot of museums in the Netherlands, consider buying a **Museumkaart** (Museum Card), which will get you unlimited free access for one year to more than 400 museums in the Netherlands! The card costs € 64,90 for adults (19 and older), € 32,45 (13-18) and € 32,45 (12 and under).

8.6 Van Gogh Brabant

The following five Brabant communities still retain traces of Van Gogh, from his sources of inspiration to his works:

- Raised in **Zundert**, memories of his youth are brought to life in the **Vincent van Gogh House**.
- History and the newest technology merge together in **Vincent's Tekenlokaal** in **Tilburg**! The young Van Gogh attended school in this former palace of King Willem II. See how he received his first serious drawing lessons in a reconstruction of this classroom and get to work in the digital art room.
- At the **Van Gogh Church in Etten-Leur**, see and hear how Van Gogh laid the foundations for his future masterpieces.
- At the **Vincentre** in **Nuenen**, witness how Van Gogh lived and painted in Nuenen, walk in the outdoor museum along all the places he painted, and experience everything the way he once experienced it!
- The **Noordbrabants Museum** in **'s-Hertogenbosch** is the leading museum containing the best of Brabant art and history. It is also the only location in Brabant where paintings by Van Gogh can be viewed. See the peasant women from *The Potato Eaters*, his father's parsonage and the unspoilt Brabant landscape for which Van Gogh was always homesick.

For more information about Van Gogh Brabant, visit

www.vangoghbrabant.nl/en

CULTURE & LEISURE

Biesbosch National Park
www.np-debiesbosch.nl

Mezz
www.mezz.nl

Chassé Theater
www.chasse.nl

Pathé Cinema
www.pathé.nl

Pathé Cinema
www.pathé.nl
Euroscop Tilburg
www.euroscop.nl
Movie Theater
Cinecitta
www.cinecitta.nl

Theatre Tilburg
www.theaterstilburg.nl
Theatre De NWE Vorst
www.denwevorst.nl

013 Poppodium
www.013.nl
Concert Hall Tilburg
www.theaterstilburg.nl
PaRaDox
www.paradoxtilburg.nl
De Link
www.delink.nl

BREDA

Breda Stedelijk Museum
www.stedelijkmuseumbreda.nl

TILBURG

Natuurmuseum Brabant
www.natuurmuseumbrabant.nl
De Pont
www.depont.nl
Textiel Museum
www.textielmuseum.nl
Vincent's Tekenlokaal
www.vincentstekenlokaal.nl

ZUNDERT

Vincent van Gogh House
www.vangoghhuus.com



Music



Cinema



Van Gogh



Theatre



Museum

**North Brabant Museum**
www.hetnoordbrabantsmuseum.nl
'S HERTOGENBOSCH**Pathé Cinema**
www.pathé.nl
Vue Eindhoven
www.vuecinemas.nl
Natlab
www.natlab.nl
Muziekgebouw Frits Philips**Eindhoven**
www.muziekgebouweindhoven.nl
De Effenaar
www.effenaar.nl
Vincent
www.vgvn.nl
HELMOND

NUENEN

Parktheater Eindhoven
www.parktheater.nl
EINDHOVEN

VELDHOVEN

Jan Visser Museum
www.janvisser-museum.nl
Helmond Museum
www.museumhelmond.nl
Theater Speelhuis
www.theaterspeelhuis.nl
Kasteel Helmond
www.museumhelmond.nl
Kunsthall Museum
www.museumhelmond.nl
De Schalm Theatre
www.deschalm.com
Museum Oude Slot
www.museumoudeslot.nl
Cinema Gold
www.cinamagold.nl
Van Abbemuseum
www.vanabbe.nl
DAF Museum
www.dafmuseum.nl
Eindhoven Museum
www.eindhovenmuseum.nl
Onomatopée
www.onomatopée.net
Philips Museum
www.philips-museum.com



VisitBrabant.com has lots of tips on places to explore in Brabant!



**VISIT
BRABANT**





"... (The Expat Center) has created some nice expats events so that we can meet other expats and locals, not to mention the extra features like the tour in some museums or stadium. For me, these events have helped a lot for connecting with others."

-- Eldon Lesley, Indonesia





Here is a small sample of events that take place in Brabant.

- **Dutch Design Week (22-30 October 2022)** is the biggest design event in Northern Europe that presents work and ideas of more than 2600 designers to more than 300,000 visitors from the Netherlands and abroad. www.ddw.nl/en/
- **GLOW 12-19 November 2022)** light art festival can be described as an exhibition in the public space of Eindhoven, of 35 famous national and international light artists. www.gloweindhoven.nl/en
- **STRP Biënnale (7-10 April 2022)** is the leading event held every two years for those with a passion for experimental technology, electronic music and spectacular art.
- **Feel Good Market** is an event full of handmade, original and inspiring products, (bio) snacks, drinks, workshops and live music. It takes place on the third Sunday of the month in Strijp-S. www.feelgoodmarket.nl
- **The Breda Jazz Festival (26-29 May 2022)** transforms Breda into a large Jazz stage with 200 concerts on almost 20 stages! www.bredajazzfestival.nl
- **Tilburg Fun Fair (22-31 July 2022)** is the largest event of its kind in the Benelux!
- **Bloemencorso Valkenswaard flower parade (11 September 2022)** consists of 14 wagons covered with dahlias, as well as bands. www.corsovalkenswaard.nl





8.7 Public Libraries

Public libraries are great places to find books in your native language (some libraries have foreign language sections), and to find information on culture in general. Libraries also organize special events.

Bibliotheek Eindhoven (Eindhoven Library)

www.bibliotheekeindhoven.nl

8.8 Nature

For nature lovers, the **national park Loonse en Drunense Duinen** is near Tilburg. Just beyond Goirle are the **Gorp and Rovert woodlands** and the **Rechte Hei** with its extensive open meadows.



There are many cycling routes that are marked and easy to follow. This can be a fun way to discover green areas outside the towns and cities.

De Groote Heide

Almost fifteen thousand (!) acres of gorgeous nature. Stretching from the green southern side of Eindhoven, past the Belgium-Dutch border and towards Hamont-Achel and Neerpelt. Six municipalities (Cranendonck, Eindhoven, Hamont-Achel, Heeze-Leende, Neerpelt and Valkenswaard) have joined forces to both nourish 'their' natural property and raise awareness for it. De Groote Heide is a diverse and varied area of natural beauty of exceptional importance on both sides of the Belgium-Dutch border. Due to its unique biodiversity, De Groote Heide ranks among the top 10 of nature reserves in Europe. And if this isn't enough of a recommendation for you: the place is also of an astounding beauty!



De Groote Heide

Almost fifteen thousand acres of nature. Stretching from the green southern side of Eindhoven, past the Belgium-Dutch border and towards Hamont-Achel and Neerpelt.

Six municipalities (Cranendonck, Eindhoven, Hamont-Achel, Heeze-Leende, Neerpelt and Valkenswaard) have joined forces to both nourish 'their' natural property and raise awareness for it.

De Groote Heide is a diverse and varied area of natural beauty of exceptional importance on both sides of the Belgium-Dutch border. Due to its unique biodiversity, De Groote Heide ranks among the top 10 of nature reserves in Europe.

De Groote Heide is a paradise for lovers of nature. Those who enjoy short walks with many a bench or picnic table along the way, surrounded by true peace and quiet. But also those more actively inclined, who like to cover greater distances faster. Also in complete peace and quiet. Because when you think De Groote Heide, you think: peace, space, hours... kilometres. Almost completely uninterrupted. Hiking, cycling, mountain biking, horseback riding, trail running...

For more information, go to:
www.degrooteheide.com





My tips

by Olivia

There are many places to explore nature in Brabant. Here are some of my favorites!



1. De Biesbosch National Park

is one of the few freshwater tidal areas in the world. Go on a Fluistertochten (Whispering Tours) to see the wildlife up close!



2. The Loonse en Drunense Duinen National Park

is called the Sahara of the Netherlands. About 3,500 hectares in size, it has the largest drifting sands in Europe.



3. There are a lot of parks to explore.

For instance, Philips de Jongh park, Karpendonkse Plas, Stadswandelpark and Gennep Parken in Eindhoven.



My tips

Jessica Richardson

Stratumse heide

We like to go walking in the forest and heathland at Stratumse heide. It's so peaceful and an easy 10 minute bus journey from Eindhoven city centre.



Heusden

We have visited the picturesque town of Heusden a few times. We usually walk around the city wall and then have lunch at the pancake house on the town square.



Klein Costa Rica

The tropical house at Kleine Costa Rica was a fun way to spend a morning during bad weather. Spotting butterflies, fish, reptiles and birds was fun for all the family. www.kleincostarica.nl



DAF museum

My toddler can't get enough of the enormous lorries, busses and fire engines on display at the DAF museum. We make good use of our museum cards!





8.9 Sports

The Netherlands prides itself on being a sporting nation. If you want to get active there are plenty of options. Indulge in over 70 different sports! The region also hosts a variety of major sports events, including the Eindhoven Marathon.

Professional sports teams

The best-known professional sports team in the Eindhoven area is the **PSV** Football Team, which has won many trophies at both the national and the European level. Founded in 1896, **Willem II** is Tilburg's professional football team. **NAC Breda** is Breda's professional football team, and a home game is known as an Avondje NAC (an NAC night)! There are also women's football teams, including **PSV Women**!

There are good sports facilities in the region, including:

- **Swimming:** The PSV swimmers train in the **Pieter van den Hoogenband Swim Stadium** at the Tongelreep National Swim Center. The region also offers natural pools and other (indoor) swimming pools, including the **Ottenbad** in Eindhoven and **Den Ekkerman** in Veldhoven.
- **Golf:** The Eindhoven area offers seven golf courses with nine holes, and Tilburg has two renowned courses.
- **The Ice Sports Centre in Eindhoven** houses three individual rinks: an ice hockey rink, a training rink and a 400-metre rink, and organizes many activities.



CULTURE & LEISURE



The National Railways Museum
www.spoorwegmuseum.nl



De Efteling
www.efteling.com

De Loonse en Drunense Duinen
www.npdeloonseendrunenseduinen.nl



Dino Hunter
www.oertijdmuseum.nl

Ireen Wüst Ice Skating Rink
www.sportintilburg.nl
Boatrentals
www.tilburgtewater.nl

BREDA

TILBURG



Safari Park
www.beeksebergen.com



ZOO Veldhoven
www.zooveldhoven.nl

VELDHOVEN



Zoo Antwerpen
www.zooantwerpen.be



Active



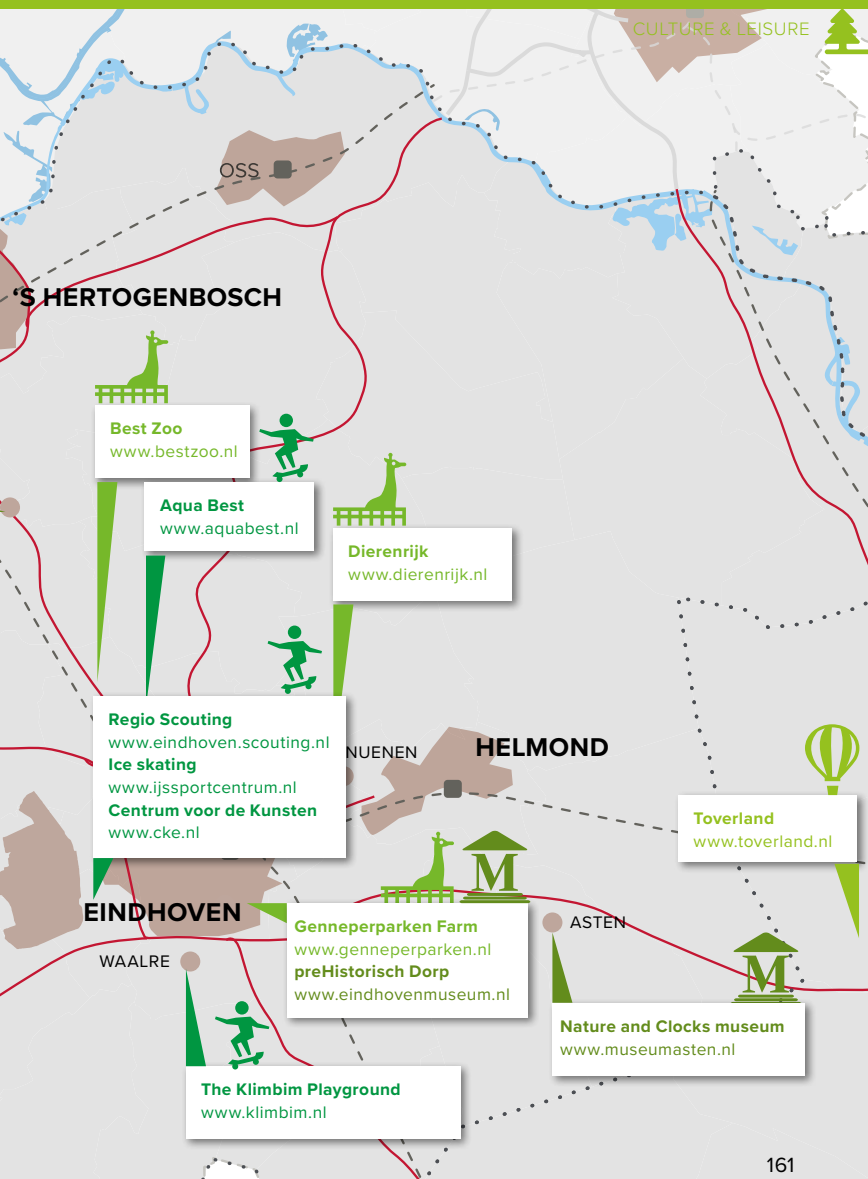
Amusement



Zoo



Museum

**Best Zoo**www.bestzoo.nl**Aqua Best**www.aquabest.nl**Dierenrijk**www.dierenrijk.nl**Regio Scouting**www.eindhoven.scouting.nl**Ice skating**www.ijssportcentrum.nl**Centrum voor de Kunsten**www.cke.nl**Toverland**www.toverland.nl**Genneperparken Farm**www.genneperparken.nl**preHistorisch Dorp**www.eindhovenmuseum.nl**Nature and Clocks museum**www.museumasten.nl**The Klimbim Playground**www.klimbim.nl



Cricket Club PSV

● www.eindhovencc.com [eindhovencc](https://www.facebook.com/eindhovencc)



The Eindhoven Raptors

● info@raptors.nl ● www.raptors.nl [ehvraptors](https://www.facebook.com/ehvraptors)



Volleyball Club Polaris

● www.vcpolaris.nl [vcpolaris](https://www.facebook.com/vcpolaris)



The Veldhoven Mixed Hockey club BASKO

● info@vmhcbasko.nl ● www.vmhcbasko.nl



The High Tech Campus Eindhoven Cricket Association

htceca.nl ● info@htceca.nl



LTV Best Tennis Padel

● padel@ltvbest.nl ● www.padel-best.nl

[Padel Best LTVBestPadel](https://www.facebook.com/Padel-Best-LTVBestPadel)

Other sports

The region has much to offer in many other sports, including (English/Dutch): Badminton-**badminton**; Basketball-**basketbal**; Climbing-**klimnsport**; Cycling-**wielersport**; Field sports-**veldsporten**; Football/soccer-voetbal; Golf-**golf**; Gymnastics-**gymnastiek/turnen**; Horse-riding-**manages/paardensport**; Ice skating-**schaatsen**; Martial arts-**vecht/zelfverdedigingssport**; Motor sport-**auto/motorsport**; Racket sports-**racket sport**; Rugby-**rugby**; Shooting/Archery- **schietsport/boogschieten**; Squash-**squash**; Tennis-**tennis**; Water sports-**watersport**

TIP!

Eindhoven Sport can answer all of your questions about where and how to participate in sports in Eindhoven! Together with Holland Expat Center South, they also organize an **Expat Sports Lounge** where you can meet sports clubs and get information. **Eindhoven sport**

CULTURE & LEISURE



Ben Wiermans
Eindhoven Sport
b.wiermans@eindhoven.nl

EXPAT SPORTS LOUNGE

Get information on how and where to participate in sports around Eindhoven



LIVING IN

Eindhoven sport



Expat Sports Lounge in November 2018 in Meindhoven.
Photos: Josine Frankhuizen

TIP!

There are about 270 non-commercial sport clubs (sportverenigingen) in Eindhoven! You can join these clubs from young to old, active or recreational, with a group or individually, from amateur to top athlete and so on.

More information: [f www.eindhovensport.nl](https://www.eindhovensport.nl)





A sports center you are proud to be a member of!

At the Student Sports Center Eindhoven (SSC) we are proud to offer an unforgettable student experience and create a community that students, staff and alumni are proud to be part of.

Get involved in Eindhoven's largest sports program

400 lessons per week in 70 different sports, fitness and (special) courses under the guidance of qualified (top sports) teachers. In our extensive (fitness) facilities you can exercise seven days per week. At our 38 student sports clubs you have the opportunity to shine in sports, gain management experience and of course enjoy the student life. So, step out of the crowd and get involved!

Home away from home

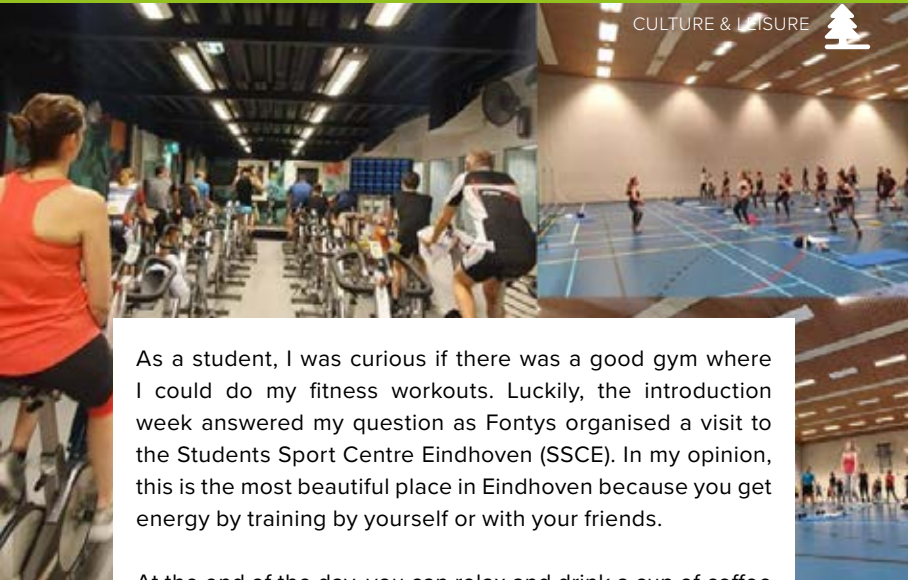
Members of the SSC hail from all provinces of the Netherlands, from every European capital and from all corners of the world. More than 100 different nationalities exercise weekly in and around the SSC. Our sports centre is the meeting place for students and staff of Fontys and the TU/e. Besides the sports program we organize various other activities for our campus visitors and residents, such as a Winter Special and Mix&Meet events.

Diversity and inclusiveness

The SSC is proud of the diverse community of TU/e and Fontys, that's why we offer everything bilingual: Dutch and English. To stimulate diversity, inclusiveness and a safe sports environment we have appointed a Diversity & Inclusion officer.

All this makes the SSC the place where you have fun, make friendships for life and develop skills you didn't even know existed!

Socials: Website   



As a student, I was curious if there was a good gym where I could do my fitness workouts. Luckily, the introduction week answered my question as Fontys organised a visit to the Students Sport Centre Eindhoven (SSCE). In my opinion, this is the most beautiful place in Eindhoven because you get energy by training by yourself or with your friends.

At the end of the day, you can relax and drink a cup of coffee in their cafeteria! The SSCE also offers several choices for group classes.

For all the classes, both men and women are welcome! Just bring a towel and a bottle of water, and your good spirit! SSCE provides all the gear!

Livia-Ana-Maria Popper Student Ambassador and President of Proxy, the English Stream study association of Fontys University of Applied Sciences.



Livia-Ana-Maria Popper

Ambassador and President of Proxy, the English Stream study association of Fontys University of Applied Sciences.



8.10 Trips Ideas Outside of Brabant

Brabant is an excellent base from which to explore other places in the Netherlands and Europe. Here are some ideas:

- Drive to Paris in 4 1/2 hours, or to Brussels or Cologne in 1 1/2 hrs.
- Flying to London, Barcelona, Berlin, Milan, Rome or Istanbul, has become affordable since several low-cost carriers began flying to and from Eindhoven Airport.

Cities in other European countries

- **Belgium:** Antwerp (www.visitbelgium.com), Brussels (www.brucity.be and www.brusselsinternational.be) and Hasselt (www.toerisme.hasselt.be)
- **Germany:** Aachen (www.aachen.de), Berlin (www.berlin-tourist-information.de) and Cologne www.koeln.de/tourismus/en/)
- **Italy:** Rome (www.romaturismo.com) and Milan (www.milanoinfotourist.com)
- **Great Britain:** London (www.visitlondon.com)
- **France:** Paris (www.parisinfo.com)
- **Spain:** Barcelona (www.barcelona-tourist-guide.com)

"I was most surprised that everyone rides a bike. Even women with skirts and high heels. I find it strange, I'm still not used to it. And I thought tulips would be everywhere, but now I know you can find them mostly in the north of the country."

-- Catalina Susnea, Romania



Rijksmuseum
www.rijksmuseum.nl
Van Gogh Museum
www.vangoghmuseum.nl
Stedelijk Museum
www.stedelijk.nl
www.iamsterdam.com



Boymans van Beuningen
www.boijmans.rotterdam.nl
Kunsthall
www.kunsthall.nl
www.vvv.rotterdam.nl

www.denhaag.com

Keukenhof
www.keukenhof.nl



Kröller-Müller Arnhem
www.kmm.nl
De Hoge Veluwe
www.hogeveluwe.nl

Deltaworks
www.deltawerken.com

Maastricht Tourist Office
www.vvmmaastricht.nl



THE EXPAT CENTER PARTNERSHIP PROGRAM

In order to help assist expats upon arrival and during their first months in the Netherlands, a distinctive collaboration has been set up between Holland Expat Center South and private service providers.

This Partnership Program redirects expats to reliable service providers in a wide variety of expat-related sectors. These Official Partners offer information on Formalities, Housing, Taxation, Finance & Insurance, Education & Careers, Personal & Social Needs, and Culture & Leisure.

More information about the Official Partners of Holland Expat Center South can be found on **www.hollandexpatcenter.com/partners/**. If you have any questions about the Partnership Program, please send us an email at: **info@hollandexpatcenter.com**



Official Partner
holland
expat center
south



OFFICIAL
PARTNERS

of Holland Expat Center South



Official Partner
holland
expat center south
2022



Moving to Brabant

The Holland Expat Center South Official Partners in 'Moving to' can assist you with any questions you have regarding the legalities of moving to the Netherlands, or your work situation.

LEGAL SERVICES



Gelijk Advocaten is a law firm that specialises in migration law and (international) family law. Our core values are: fast, professional and no nonsense.

- +31 (0)73 750 2828 ● info@gelijkadvocaten.nl
- www.gelijkadvocaten.nl



Maes Law is specialized in employment and migration law. We advise clients all over the world on national and European migration issues (service provision, intra company transfers, etc.) and guide them through the procedures. ● +31 (0)85 902 1270 ● info@maeslaw.nl

- www.maeslaw.nl



Pallas Attorneys-at-Law is specialized in international employment law. We are experienced in advising and representing expats and internationally operating companies in a wide range of employment matters.

- +31 (0)85 070 4712 ● michelle.maijen@pallas.nl
- www.pallas.nl



SCG Lawyers is specialized in (international) family law, inheritance law, juvenile law and mediation. We advise clients in the Netherlands and all over the world.

- +31 (0)88 909 4904 ● cvandervegt@scg-advocaten.nl
- www.scg-advocaten.nl/en

RELOCATION SERVICES

DEDICATED RELOCATION SERVICES EINDHOVEN



Big5 Relocation is a locally based relocation office in Eindhoven. An experienced team always ensures a smooth and efficient transition for the expat. Big5 offers dedicated relocation services in Eindhoven.

- +31 (0)40 235 1505 ● sander.veenman@big5relo.com
- www.big5relo.com

expatmanagementgroup



What's in a name?! **Expat Management Group** is a corporate mobility consultancy delivering specialized services in expat mobility management - Immigration, Relocation & Tax - providing comprehensive solutions for corporates and individuals alike.

- +31 (0)20 707 0551 ● info@expatmanagementgroup.com
- www.expatmanagementgroup.com



GoodGuide The hassle-free way to bring top talent to your business from around the world with a friendly, tech-led solution that manages the processes and helps your new hires settle in.

- +31 (0)85 047 1965 ● Hello@usegoodguide.com
- www.usegoodguide.com



Packimpex has fourteen offices across Switzerland, Germany, Belgium, UK, the Netherlands and offers destination services, temporary living services, corporate apartment management, visa and immigration services, and the coordination of moves.

- +31 (0)6-288 16150 ● info.nl@packimpex.com
- www.packimpex.nl



The global mobility partner for Immigration Support & Relocation Care, who keeps your organization compliant and your international employees happy. We take it personal, we make it personal!

- + 31 (0)85 620 4900 ● info@pirgroup.com
- www.pirgroup.com

NOTARY



Notariskantoor Broekmans will make sure that all necessary legal documents regarding the purchase and mortgage of your house are carefully drawn up, explained and signed. You just sit back and concentrate on turning your new house into your home!

- +31 (0)40 213 6360 ● info@jouwnotaris.nl
- www.jouwnotaris.nl



Living in Brabant

The Official Partners in 'Living in' can assist you in finding suitable housing during your stay. Housing is available in different categories, and for various budgets. There are also hotels that offer long-term stay rooms.

RENTALS

corporate housing factory

Corporate Housing Factory offers modern serviced apartments for temporary stays in Eindhoven, Amsterdam, Rotterdam and The Hague. Always conveniently located with easy access to the city center, main business areas, airports and public transportation.

- +31 (0)88 1169 500
- info@corporatehousingfactory.com
- www.corporatehousingfactory.com



CORPORATE
HOUSING
SOLUTIONS

Corporate Housing Solutions is a one-stop-shop for your short-stay or long-stay housing needs (rent or buy). We specialize in helping internationals. Let's get you comfortable!

- +31 (0)40 218 0070 ● info@corporatehousingsolutions.nl
- www.corporatehousingsolutions.nl

PURCHASE



AB Makelaars provides tailored, independent and professional advice and assistance in buying a home in the Netherlands. You can find our office in the center of Eindhoven; The Knowledge City.

- +31 (0)40 243 6335
- info@abmakelaars.nl ● www.abmakelaars.nl



Want to live in the Eindhoven area? With two offices in Eindhoven and Weert **Dwars Makelaars** is your professional guide. Let us help you to sell, buy or value your house.

- +31 (0)49 553 7599 ● info@dwarsmakelaars.nl
- www.dwarsmakelaars.nl



Our internationals are here for all your housing questions: We offer assistance in buying, renting, selling and mortgages. **Easie housing** is part of the vb&t group.

- +31 (0)40 269 6949 ● mail@easie.nu
- www.easiehousing.nl



Garantiemakelaars Brainport region With two branches in the brainport region, our mission is to relieve expats of all their housing issues. We guide you through the purchase, sale or rental of properties.

- Eindhoven: +31 (0)40 295 7957
- Nuenen: +31 (0)40 290 7000



Contact **Janssen Steijlen** when you are planning to buy a house for the first time in the Netherlands or if you wish to sell your home.

- +31 (0)40 295 4678
- freek@janssensteijlen.nl ● www.janssensteijlen.nl



Whether you're renting or buying existing or new build property, we'll find the ideal solution. **Van Santvoort Makelaars** also gives excellent advice on financing, contracts and property tax deduction.

- +31 (0)40 269 2530 ● info@eindhoven.vansantvoort.nl
- www.vansantvoort.nl



Debbie Mels
Lommers Makelaars

BUYING AGENT

Looking for your dreamhouse in the Brabant area? The estate agents of **Debbie Mels Lommers Makelaars** will help you and look after your interests throughout the entire purchasing process.

- +31 (0)40 294 8000
- eindhoven@lommersmakelaars.nl
- www.debbiemels.nl

MORTGAGE ADVISOR

EXPAT MORTGAGES
where you feel at home

Expat Mortgages is the fastest way to your mortgage in The Netherlands. We have helped thousands of expats from over 75 nationalities and we make you feel at home.

- +31 (0)20 717 3908
- info@expatmortgages.nl ● www.expatmortgages.nl

Freek,
zorgt voor je hypotheek

Freek Hypotheek offers one-stop shopping for personal and independent advice and mediation in mortgages and insurances from 50 different mortgage lenders and insurance companies.

- +31 (0)40 292 2222
- eindhoven@freekhypotheek.nl
- www.freekhypotheek.nl/en

MOVERS



Gebr. Van den Eijnden Euromovers specializes in domestic and international removals. Through our worldwide network of reliable partners we can support you with your relocation to/from any location, with personal care.

● +31 (0)40 281 8888 ● info@movers.nl ● www.movers.nl

HOTELS



THE STUDENT HOTEL

By merging flexible-stay accommodations with luxury facilities, **The Student Hotel** provides a fun co-living environment in the center of Eindhoven where multicultural expats can live, work, play and connect.

● +31 (0)40 231 9792
● info@studenthotel.com ● www.thestudenthotel.com

HOME APPLIANCES



Homie provides sustainable home appliances though Pay-Per-Use combined with a flexible Contract (6 Months). Effortless - Sustainable - Pay-Per-Use

● +31 (15) 7601615
● info@homiegroup.com ● www.homiepayperuse.com/en



Working in Brabant

The Official Partners in 'Working in' provide assistance in filing taxes, banking and insurance. These companies have experience with helping internationals, and have offices in the region.

TAXATION



Blue Umbrella helps internationals manage their Dutch tax matters. Affordable, conveniently on-line and transparent. Blue Umbrella specializes in tax return, tax compliance and childcare subsidy. Income Tax Filing €145.

- +31 (0)20 468 7560
- info@blueumbrella.nl ● www.blueumbrella.nl



Crowe Foederer HR Services Global mobility specialists with 50+ years' experience that assist employers/expats around the world with permits, 30%-ruling, payroll and tax/social security support, technology and advice, offering the one-stop-shop solution in Eindhoven.

- +31 (0)40 264 9610
- r.oers@crowefoederer.nl ● www.foederer.nl



DRV Accountants & Adviseurs can assist with accountancy services, national and international tax services and financial consultancy.

- + 31 (0)76 523 3033
- oosterhout@drv.nl ● www.drv.nl



EY is your contact when it comes to tax and social security aspects of international mobility. Our global network enables us to answer your questions in a practical way.

- + 31 (0)6 2908 4095
- stijn.wichers@nl.ey.com ● www.ey.com



Meijer & Co Tax Lawyers KPMG's People Services brings together a wealth of income & wage tax, social security, technology and immigration services to help make managing your global workforce easier, safer and more efficient.

- +31 88 909 3155
- vandijk.rachel@kpmg.com
- www.meijburg.com



Tax is Exciting! Would you like to have your income tax return processed? Our team is ready for you! We work with fixed fees, but simple questions are answered for free.

- +31 (0)20 520 7991
- info@orangetax.nl ● www.orangetax.com



The TaxSavers

The TaxSavers is an all-round tax advisor which can assist you with all your questions regarding your Dutch taxes, the M-form and the annual income tax return.

- +31 (0)20 217 0120
- info@taxsavers.nl ● www.taxsavers.nl



FINANCE & INSURANCE

**ABN-AMRO**

ABN AMRO International Clients Retail Eindhoven

We've been a trusted financial partner and specialist for expats. For example we offer tailor made expat mortgages and opening a Dutch bank account takes less than 10 minutes.

- +31 (0)20 343 4002 ● appointment@abnamro.nl
- www.abnamro.nl/en/personal/specially-for/expats/index

**Rabobank**

In order to help expatriates in the Netherlands with their specific questions and needs, **Rabobank** has set up a specialized expatriate service in Eindhoven: the Rabobank Expat Desk.

- +31 (0)40 293 6000
- Info.Eindhoven-Veldhoven@rabobank.nl
- www.rabobank.nl/eindhoven-veldhoven

voor het leven
Sociale Verzekeringsbank

The **Sociale Verzekeringsbank** has departments specialized in social security for cross border workers or students who start living, working, studying or doing business in Belgium (Bureau for Belgian Affairs) or Germany (Bureau for German Affairs).

- +31 (0)76 548 5000
- www.svb.nl/bbz (Belgium)
- +31 (0)24 343 1811
- www.svb.nl/bdz (Germany)



Studying and Working in Brabant

These Official Partners can offer you assistance and guidance in furthering your education, volunteering and finding a job.

BRAINPORT DEVELOPMENT
economic development agency

Brainport Development is a new-style economic development agency that works with representatives from industry, knowledge institutes and government to strengthen Brainport Eindhoven top technology region.

- www.brainport.nl/organisatie



BRAVENTURE
BE BRAVE, BUILD YOUR BUSINESS

Braventure is a non-profit partnership between thirteen parties, powered by the province of Noord-Brabant. Our common goal is to accelerate your Brabant startup through knowledge, development, community and financing.

- www.braventure.nl ● info@braventure.nl

edufax global
educational
mobility

Just arrived to the Netherlands? **Edufax** supports families and global mobility teams to make the best decisions regarding children's educational development and well-being before, during, and after a relocation.

- support@edufax.nl ● www.edufax.nl



Expatspouses Initiative has built a strong community and ecosystem of companies in the region in order to connect the highly-skilled partners of international employees with local job opportunities.

- www.expatspousesinitiative.org

**KIT** Royal Tropical Institute

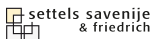
'Cultures don't meet, people do.' At **KIT Intercultural Professionals** we equip organizations, teams, leaders and professionals with the skills and competencies to thrive in this increasingly interconnected and intercultural world.

- +31 (0)20 568 8319
- www.kit.nl/intercultural-professionals/

**high tech institute**

High Tech Institute Facilitates growth of individuals & teams worldwide, both in technical width, depth & soft skills. Expats' training: "How to be succesful in the Dutch high tech work culture".

- +31 (0)40 851 2061 ● training@hightechinstitute.nl
- www.hightechinstitute.nl



CHILDCARE



International Childcare Eindhoven offers professional Dutch day care and out of school care with an international dimension from the campus of International School Eindhoven (ISE).

- +31 (0)40 249 0238 ● L.dewilde@childcareeindhoven.nl
- www.childcareeindhoven.nl

**Korein**

Children develop best when they are happy in their own skin. Helping children be happy is our most important task at **Korein**. Call on us for day care, playgroups, lunchtime and after school care.

- +31 (0)40 294 8989 ● klantadvies@korein.nl
- www.koreinkinderplein.nl/en/



Little Jungle Kinderopvang provides day care, pre-school, open play time and after school care. Children learn the Dutch language while playing, make friends, do fun activities and have a great day!

- +31 (0)40 237 5761 ● info@littlejungle.nl
- www.littlejungle.nl

LANGUAGE SCHOOLS



Basten Trainingen offers all levels of Dutch language courses for expats, spouses, international students, children with a personal and practical focus & guidance towards work & study. Small groups, individual training, in-company training.

- +31 (0)6 20998707 ● mbasten@bastentrainingen.nl
- www.bastentrainingen.nl



Dutch course? Of course! teaches conversational lessons to expat(families). If you are motivated, you will be able to talk Dutch from the very first lesson. Fast, friendly, flexible and always fun!

- +31(0)6 5123 6231
- info@dcoc.nl ● www.dcoc.nl



Language Institute Regina Coeli is the foremost specialist in intensive and individual language training for the business community, government institutions and private citizens, within and outside the Netherlands.

- +31 (0)73 684 8790 ● planning@reginacoeli.nl
- www.reginacoeli.nl



STE Languages offers special Dutch group courses (regular or intense) for expats starting five times per year for the levels A1- up to C1. Check our website for details.

- +31 (0)40 245 2860 ● info@STE.nl ● www.STE.nl



Volksuniversiteit regio Eindhoven offers Dutch courses for expats and internationals in all levels to A1 -> C1. We offer courses once or twice a week in Eindhoven and Veldhoven.

● +31 (0)40 782 0810

● info@vu-eindhoven.nl ● www.vu-eindhoven.nl



Voorwaartz delivers custom made language and communication training and intensive courses in Dutch as a second language (NT2) for companies throughout the Netherlands. How we can help you go 'Forwardz'?

● +31 (0)76 521 9884 ● info@voorwaartz.nl

● www.voorwaartz.nl

SCHOOLS



International School Breda believes that your child's learning experience should be fun, exciting and challenging! We're proud to offer excellent primary and secondary international education under one roof.

● +31 (0)76 560 7870 ● info@isbreda.com

● www.internationalschoolbreda.nl



The **International School Eindhoven** primary department offers English and Dutch Primary Education, and its secondary department offers the International Baccalaureate Middle Years Programme and the International Baccalaureate Diploma Years.

● +31 (0)40 251 9437 ● www.isecampus.nl

VOLUNTEER WORK



Volunteer work is fun, challenging, educational, and good for your personal development. If volunteer work is something you would like to do, **Eindhoven Doet** will search with you to find a suitable position!

● +31 (0)40 219 3399 ● www.eindhovendoet.nl



Personal & Social Needs

The Official Partners in 'Personal & Social Needs' can offer you assistance in adapting to life in the Netherlands.

COACHING



Expath Coaching provides virtual life coaching for English speakers living in the Netherlands and specializes in work with youth and young adults.

- +31 (0)6 1543 5347
- info@expath-coaching.nl
- expath-coaching.nl

MOBILE COMMUNICATIONS



Lebara Let us make your life a little bit easier. With flexible Sim Only, Prepaid and affordable extra bundles and add-ons. All on a superfast network with maximum coverage.

- +31 (0)6 19001200
- mobile.lebara.com/nl/en/expats



HEALTH CARE



The midwives from **Midwifery Practice Eindhoven** will guide you through your pregnancy, delivery and the first weeks after birth. Working with expats is one of our specialties.

- +31 (0)6 28069584 ● info@kinderrijkmeerhoven.nl
- www.midwiferypractice-eindhoven.nl



Re-align method (holistic health hacking) is based on neurology, physiology and experience. Experience the power of your own body and breath to (re)discover your health.

- +31 (0)6 1530 2487 ● hi@re-align.nl ● www.re-align.nl



SGE INTERNATIONAL
HEALTH CARE SERVICES

At **SGE International**, the visitor can expect a global approach with a medical team, which has been trained to understand the needs of people from different international backgrounds.

- +31 (0)40 711 6730
- international@sge.nl ● www.sgeinternational.nl

TRANSPORT



Dekker is a professional driving school that specializes in helping and training foreigners to prepare for the Dutch driving and theory exams. We have English-speaking instructors.

- +31 (0)40 444 4444
- info@rijkschooldekker.nl ● www.rijkschooldekker.nl



Culture & Leisure

The Official Partners in Culture & Leisure offer different activities that you can enjoy in the region. The Media Partners provide news and information in English.

CULTURE



CKE is the home of amateur arts and cultural education in Eindhoven. Choose from a broad range of courses and lessons in music, dance, visual arts, photography, theatre, and more.

- +31 (0)40 216 3263 ● info@cke.nl
- cke.nl/about/



Effenaar is the largest pop venue of Eindhoven, existing since 1971. We host the entire range of pop music. Musicians from all over the world play at the venue.

- +31 (0)40 239 3666 ● info@effenaar.nl
- www.effenaar.nl



The Eindhoven Library facilitates everyone in Eindhoven in their personal development. We offer a large collection of (e-)books and organize fascinating workshops, lectures and other activities. The entire city benefits!

- +31 (0)40 260 4260
- klantenservice@bibliotheekeindhoven.nl
- www.bibliotheekeindhoven.nl



Muziekgebouw Frits Philips Eindhoven is a contemporary music hall with international allure. An acoustic top-location that is extremely popular among world-famous orchestras and soloists in the heart of Eindhoven.

- +31 (0)40 244 2020
- tickets@MuziekgebouwEindhoven.nl
- www.muziekgebouweindhoven.nl



NatLab screens movies from all over the world with English subtitles. There's also: Q&A's with movie directors, impressive theatre performances, English film courses and kids' workshops, and more!

- +31 (0)40 294 6848
- www.natlab.nl/english
- www.facebook.com/natlabenglish



Parktheater Eindhoven offers over 450 performances per season. Including: Music, dance, opera, comedy, acrobatics and other shows without language. Plus, whenever possible Dutch plays with English support text.

- +31 (0)40 211 1122
- www.parktheater.nl/internationals/



The **Van Abbemuseum** in Eindhoven is one of the first public museums for contemporary art to be established in Europe. Besides its art's role in society, the museum contains space for hiring, like the auditorium and studio.

- +31(0)40 238 1042
- www.vanabbemuseum.nl



Van Gogh Brabant Five Brabant communities retain traces of Van Gogh. He was born and raised here, and produced his first masterpiece 'The Potato Eaters' here. Welcome to Van Gogh's homeland!

- info@vangoghbrabant.com
- www.vangoghbrabant.com

LEISURE



Together with the leisure sector, government and umbrella organisations, **VisitBrabant** puts the province of Brabant firmly on the map as Europe's most welcoming and innovative region.

- www.visitbrabant.com



VVV Eindhoven Tourist Information Office Your visit to Eindhoven starts at the VVV (Tourist Information Office), the address for all tourist information about Eindhoven and its surroundings. Concert tickets, various gift vouchers and souvenirs are also available at VVV Eindhoven.

- 0900 1122 363
- www.vvveindhoven.nl



VVV Veldhoven Tourist Information Office

The VVV specializes in regional information and is able to help you plan a day trip, a group-activity or to find a cycling route. Please drop by!

- +31 (0)40 253 2901 ● info@vvv-veldhoven.nl
- www.vvv-veldhoven.nl



SPORTS



The Blue Zone Gym The newest boutique gym in the middle of the Park in the city center of Eindhoven. We will guide you to a better lifestyle and welcome you to our beautiful city.

- +31(0)40 843 7855 ● eindhoven@thebluezonegym.nl
- www.thebluezonegym.nl



Here at **David Lloyd Eindhoven** we're in a great location, on the outskirts of Veldhoven. With something for everyone – come and join the club.

- +31 (0)40 253 8125 ● eindhoven@davidlloyd.nl
- www.davidlloyd.nl

Eindhoven
sport



Eindhoven Sport marks the start of a day, a season or even a lifetime of sports. In Eindhoven you have numerous sporting opportunities at your fingertips. Check out our website for more information!

- +31 (0)40 238 1151 ● sport@eindhoven.nl
- www.eindhovensport.com



FC Eindhoven is a football club based in Eindhoven (The Netherlands). The first team is playing in the second league of Holland, the Keuken Kampioen Divisie.

- +31 (0)40 211 2967 ● info@fc-eindhoven.nl
- www.fc-eindhoven.nl/fce-international/



The Gulbergen golfclub is a very healthy and lively club with 1,100 members. Exists for over 25 years and is an inviting, low key club and open to all "newcomers".

- +31 (0)49 259 2455
- www.golfdegulbergen.nl



MEDIA PARTNERS



Stichting Brabant Ondernemt is an enterprising, independent business network with ambition and a no-nonsense attitude. We actively create connections between government, education and entrepreneurs (in Brabant).

● www.brabantonderneemt.nl



DutchNews.nl keeps you up to date with the latest Dutch news - in English - online, by mobile or email newsletter. From politics to personalities, from football to Philips.

● www.dutchnews.nl



Eindhoven News Your local daily news in English! At the online news site you can find daily news in English of what is happening in Eindhoven and surroundings.

● www.eindhovennews.nl



“HOWDO” is the first English written magazine for expats, foreign students and all internationals in the region of Eindhoven.

● www.howdo.info



XPat Media is the organization behind publications geared towards expatriates.

● www.xpatmedia.nl



EDITOR'S NOTE

We hope that this guide helps you to settle into Brabant! If you have tips for the next edition of the guide, please send us an email: info@hollandexpatcenter.com.

In the meantime, please enjoy your time in Brabant!

And whenever you have any questions, please know that you are always welcome to contact Holland Expat Center South. We are here to help you!

Kind regards,

Olivia van den Broek-Neri

Holland Expat Center South

Notes

Ruled area for notes with horizontal dotted lines.



Notes

COLOPHON

The International Student's Guide to Brabant. A publication of Holland Expat Center South

March 2022

PHOTOGRAPHS

Bert Keet, Boudewijn Bollmann, Brabant Development Agency (BOM), Brainport Development, Brbbl, DAF Museum, Diewke van den Heuvel, Dutch Design Week, Eindhoven Airport, Elena Albuene, Eleonora Testa, Fotomedia, Frank Tielemans, Geert van Buul (Buurtvereniging Grashoek), Gemeente Bergeijk, Gemeente Breda, Gemeente Eersel, Gemeente Eindhoven, Gemeente Helmond, Gemeente Laarbeek, Gemeente Nuenen, Gemeente Son en Breugel, Gemeente Tilburg, Gemeente Veldhoven, Gemeente Waalre, Historisch Openlucht Museum Eindhoven (HOME), Joop van der Kaa, Josine Frankhuizen Justyna van de Wal, Keyport 2020, Lenka Cizkova Photography, Marjan Holmer, Martin van Rooij, Michiel Landeweerd, Ministerie van Verkeer en Waterstaat, Patrick Meis, Philips, Regional International School (RIS), Sjoerd Leeuwenberg, Stichting Van Gogh Village Nuenen, TU/e, Typical Holland, Van De Wal productions, Van Abbemuseum, Vincent van den Hoogen, VVV Eindhoven/Paul Veltman, VVV Tilburg, Yvonne Simons.

Editor Olivia van den Broek - Neri and Mira Dreessen

Layout Mariëtte van Oort

Print Gemeente Eindhoven

Disclaimer

In the compilation of this guide various sources have been consulted and a number of organisations have lent their cooperation and provided information. Holland Expat Center South has verified this information as far as possible with authorities and experts. Nevertheless we remain dependent on external sources. We cannot, therefore, accept any liability for any errors and their consequences. We advise you at all times to get advice from your HR department or the relevant official bodies.

Holland Expat Center South is a joint initiative of the participating municipalities, the Immigration and Naturalisation Services (IND), Brainport Development, and the province Noord-Brabant

Provincie Noord-Brabant

BRAINPORT DEVELOPMENT
economic development agency



Immigration and Naturalisation
Service
*Ministry of the Interior and
Kingdom Relations*

